Completed Staff Work (CSW) Training

Municipal Local Government of Paglat
Maguindanao del Sur, BARMM
April 25 – 27, 2024

CSW Training for LGUs

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The CSW Sessions at a Glance

1. Introduction to Completed Staff Work (CSW)
2. Importance of CSW in Local Governance
3. Competencies of CSW Practitioners
4. 5-Step CSW Process
   a. Analyzing the Context
   b. Defining the Problem or Need
   c. Research and Analyzing Needed Information
   d. Exploring Options or Alternatives
   e. Submitting the Proposal or Report
5. Writeshop on CSW Guidelines

SESSION 1

Introduction to Completed Staff Work

Session 1

INTRODUCTION TO COMPLETED STAFF WORK

- Concept and History of Completed Staff Work
- Importance of CSW in Local Governance
- Overview of the 5-Step CSW Process

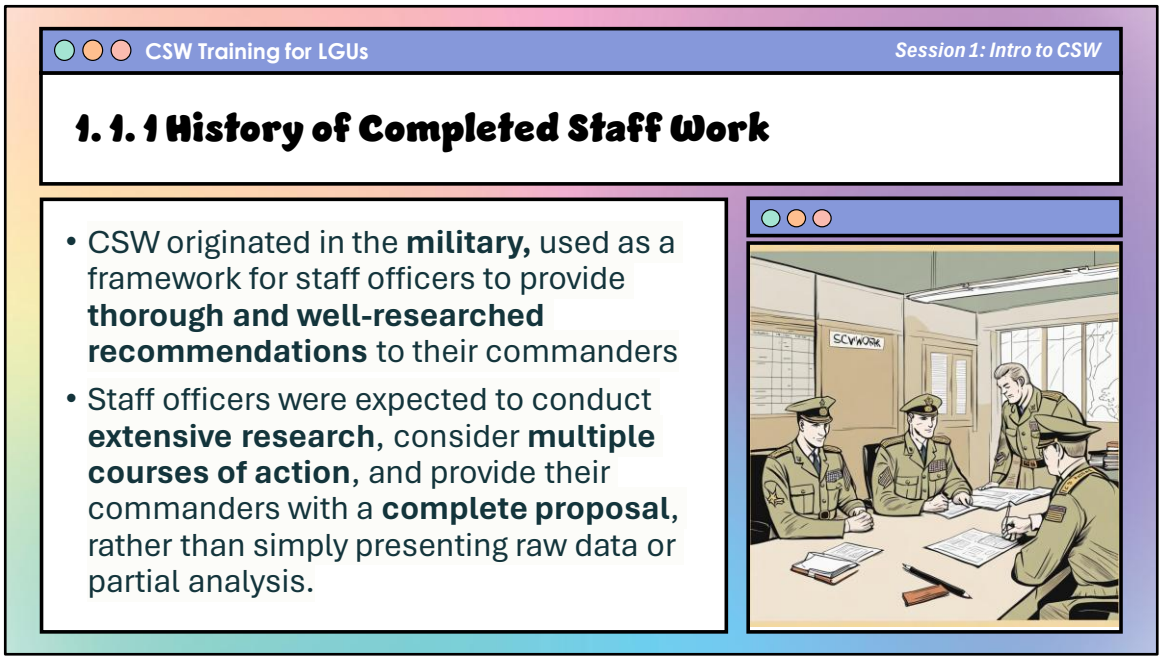
Introductory Activity:
CSW can be fun!

Introductory Activity:

Appreciating CSW through Building a Marshmallow Tower

30 min

1.1 History and Concept of Completed Staff Work



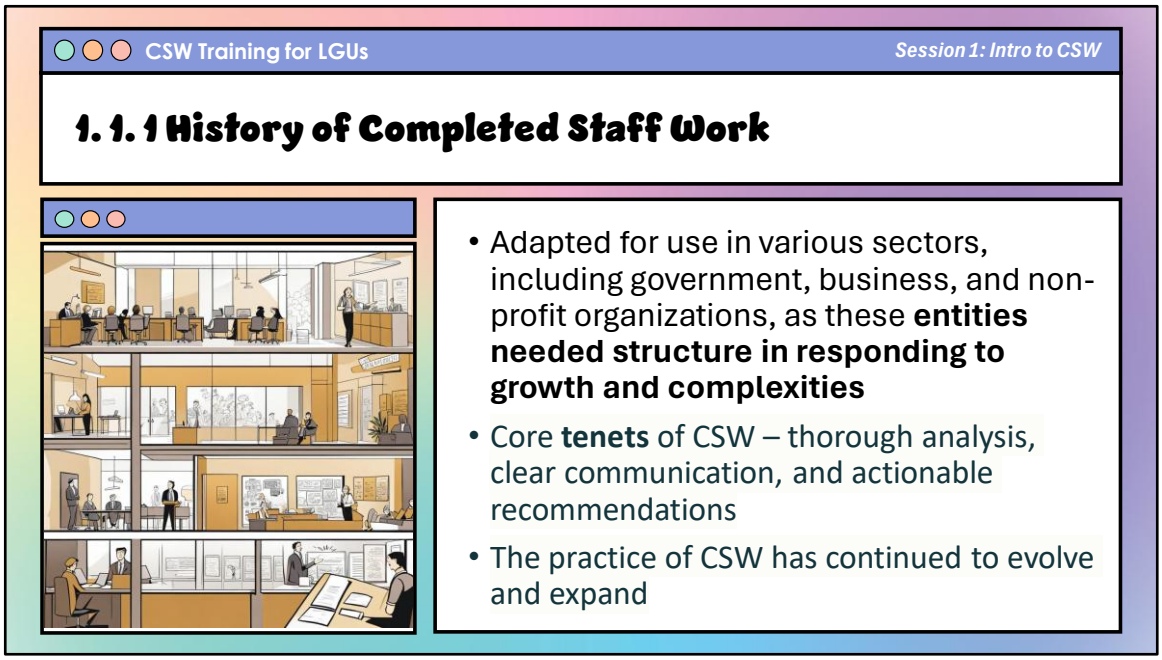
1.1.1 History of Completed Staff Work

Completed Staff Work, or CSW, traces its origins to the military, where it emerged as a systematic approach for staff officers to provide comprehensive recommendations to commanding officers. The principles of CSW were developed to ensure that proposals presented to military leaders were thoroughly researched, carefully analyzed, and actionable.

Origins in Military Planning
The concept of CSW arose from the need for efficient and effective decision-making in complex military operations. In the chaos of battle, commanders relied on their staff to gather intelligence, assess risks, and develop strategic plans. However, incomplete or poorly prepared staff work could lead to flawed decisions with potentially catastrophic consequences.

To address this challenge, military staff work evolved to emphasize rigorous analysis, clear communication, and the presentation of well-reasoned recommendations. Staff officers were expected to conduct extensive research, consider multiple courses of action, and provide their commanders with a

complete proposal, rather than simply presenting raw data or partial analysis.



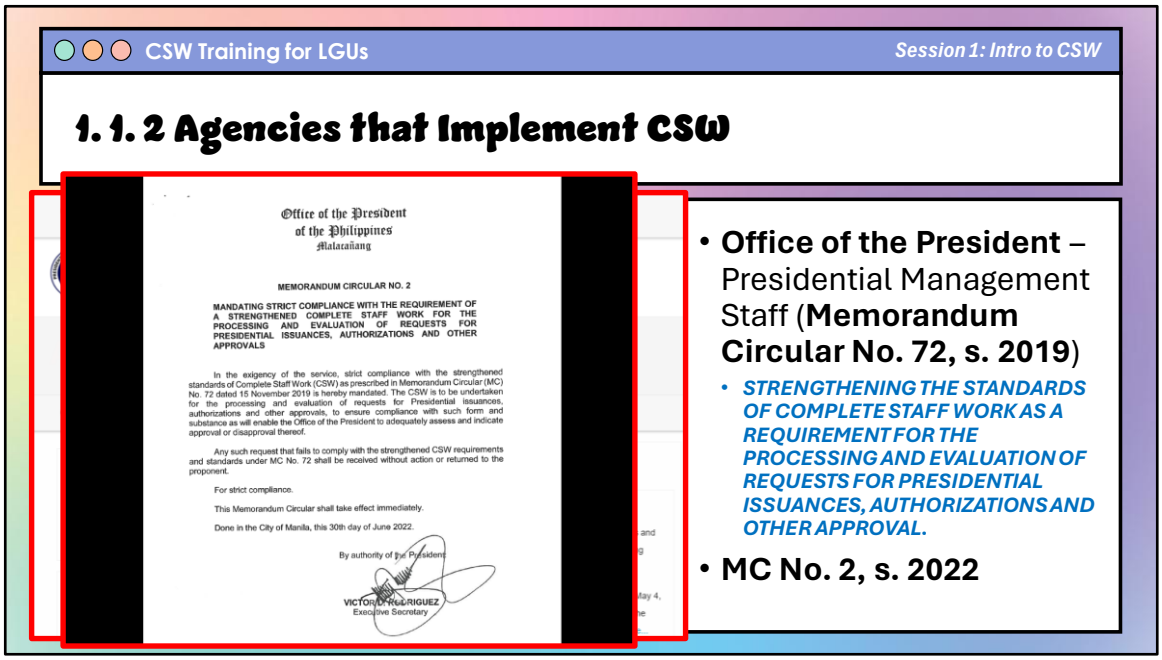
Adaptation to Civilian Organizations
As the 20th century progressed, the principles of CSW began to be adopted by civilian organizations facing increasing complexity and growth. Government agencies, businesses, and non-profit organizations recognized the value of a structured approach to problem-solving and decision-making.

The core tenets of CSW – thorough research, critical analysis, and actionable recommendations – proved universally applicable, regardless of the sector or industry. By embracing CSW, organizations could ensure that decisions were based on comprehensive information, potential risks and opportunities were carefully evaluated, and resources were allocated effectively.

Expansion and Evolution
Over time, the practice of CSW has continued to evolve and expand. Advances in technology, data analysis, and project management methodologies have influenced the tools and techniques used in the CSW process. However, the fundamental principles of CSW remain unchanged – to provide decision-makers with complete, well-reasoned proposals that enable informed and decisive action.

Today, CSW is widely recognized as a best practice in fields as diverse as public administration, strategic planning, policy development, and organizational change management. It has become an essential component of effective leadership and governance, ensuring that decisions are grounded in evidence, aligned with organizational goals, and responsive to stakeholder needs.

The enduring relevance of CSW can be attributed to its emphasis on rigor, objectivity, and accountability. By following a systematic approach to problem-solving and proposal development, organizations can navigate complex challenges, mitigate risks, and seize opportunities for growth and improvement.



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1. 1. 2 Agencies that Implement CSW

- **Department of Health**
- **Department of Education**
- **Bureau of Customs**
- **Tourism Infrastructure and Enterprise Zone Authority**
- **GSIS**
- **PDIC**

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1. 1. 3 What is Completed Staff Work?

1. CSW is a **systematic approach** to ***decision-making, problem-solving,*** and ***proposal development*** that aims to ensure staff work is comprehensive, accurate, and actionable
2. CSW enables decision-makers to **make informed choices** and **take decisive action** by providing them with complete, well-reasoned recommendations
3. **No "half-baked" ideas;** decisions-makers **only approve and disapprove**

1.1.2 What is Completed Staff Work?

At its core, Completed Staff Work (CSW) is a systematic approach to decision-making, problem-solving, and proposal development that aims to ensure staff work is comprehensive, accurate, and actionable. It is a structured process that emphasizes thorough research, critical analysis, and the presentation of well-reasoned recommendations to decision-makers.

The primary goal of CSW is to enable decision-makers to make informed choices and take decisive action based on the comprehensive groundwork laid by their staff1. By receiving complete, well-articulated proposals, leaders can focus on the key issues and implications, rather than getting bogged down in incomplete or ***"half-baked"*** ideas.

1.1.4 CSW vs. SUPERVISION

- Staff members report to supervisors
- Staff members submit documents to supervisors; CSW is required
- Supervisors perform the following:
  - Delegation of work
  - Managing and evaluating performance
  - Feedback and coaching
  - Managing conflict
  - Employee engagement

Easier to observe and build.
Competencies
Skills and behaviors required for success that can be observed.
FOR EXAMPLE:
Decision quality, strategic mindset, global perspective, and business insight.
Experiences
Assignments or roles that prepare a person for future roles.
FOR EXAMPLE:
Functional experiences, international assignments, turnarounds, and fix-its.
Indicators of readiness for a role.
What you do
Who you are
Traits
Inclinations and natural tendencies a person leans toward, including personality traits.
FOR EXAMPLE:
Assertiveness, risk taking, and confidence.
Drivers
Values and interests that influence a person's career path, motivation, and engagement.
FOR EXAMPLE:
Power, status, autonomy, and challenge.
Harder to observe and build.
Indicators of potential for a role.

Performance	Potential	Readiness	Fit
How **effective** is a person in their current role?	Does a person have the future capacity to be **effective** in a more challenging role at a higher level?	How prepared is a person in the near-term to **perform** in a more challenging role or level?	How well suited is a person to the specific role, business context, and culture?

What to assess for:

- Competencies and Traits needed for current role.

- Experiences, Traits, and Drivers needed for broader, deeper, or more complex roles or higher levels in the future.

- Competencies and Experiences needed for broader or next level roles soon.

- Competencies, Experiences, Traits, and Drivers needed now for a specific role, business context, and culture.

1. 1. 4 Key Principles of Completed Staff Work

1. *Thorough Research and Analysis*
2. *Clear and Concise Communication*
3. *Actionable Recommendations*
4. *Comprehensive and Complete Proposals*
5. *Continuous Improvement*

Key Principles of CSW:

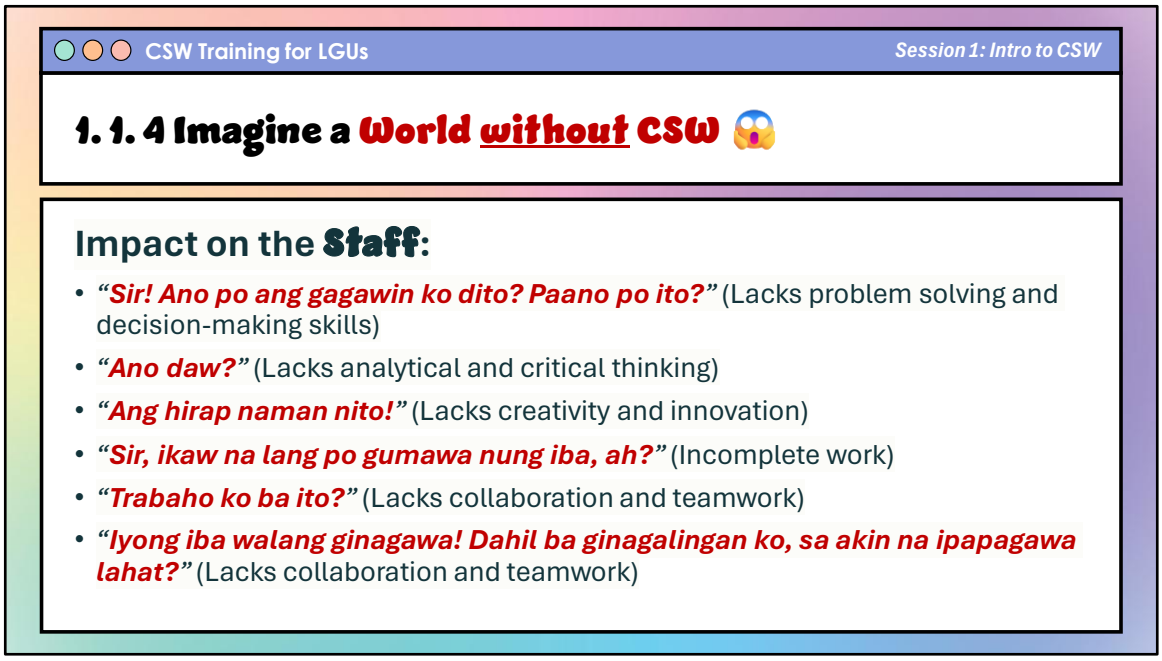
1.Thorough Research and Analysis
CSW requires staff to conduct extensive research and gather all relevant information related to the issue or problem at hand. This involves considering multiple perspectives, exploring various options and alternatives, and critically evaluating potential solutions.

2.Clear and Concise Communication
Effective communication is essential in CSW. Staff must present their findings and recommendations in a clear, well-organized, and logical manner, using language that is accessible and free of jargon. Visual aids, such as graphs and charts, can also be employed to convey complex information more effectively.

3.Actionable Recommendations
Perhaps most crucially, CSW emphasizes the development of actionable recommendations1. Rather than simply presenting data or analysis, staff work should culminate in a specific proposal for action that is feasible, realistic, and aligned with the organization's goals and objectives.

4.Comprehensive and Complete Proposals
A key principle of CSW is that staff should not present decision-makers with open-ended questions or partial analyses1. Instead, they are expected to carry out the necessary legwork to develop fully-formed, comprehensive proposals that decision-makers can approve or disapprove.

5.Continuous Improvement
CSW is an iterative process that encourages continuous learning and improvement. By regularly engaging in staff work, organizations can refine their understanding of complex issues, adapt to changing circumstances, and make better decisions over time.



1.1.4 Imagine a World without CSW

In a world without Completed Staff Work (CSW), the Municipality of Paglat would face significant challenges in delivering effective and responsive governance to its constituents. The absence of a systematic approach to problem-solving and decision-making would have far-reaching impacts on staff, supervisors, the Mayor, and ultimately, the people of Paglat.

Impact on the Staff:
Without the structure and guidance provided by CSW, staff members would likely struggle with problem-solving and decision-making tasks. Common refrains might include:

"Sir! Ano po ang gagawin ko dito? Paano po ito?" (Lacks problem-solving and decision-making skills)
"Ano daw?" (Lacks analytical and critical thinking)
"Ang hirap naman nito!" (Lacks creativity and innovation)
"Sir, ikaw na lang po gumawa nung iba, ah?" (Incomplete work)
"Trabaho ko ba ito?" (Lacks collaboration and teamwork)

"Iyong iba walang ginagawa! Dahil ba ginagalingan ko, sa akin na ipapagawa lahat?" (Lacks collaboration and teamwork)

Without a clear process to follow, staff may feel overwhelmed, lack direction, and struggle to complete their work effectively and efficiently. This could lead to frustration, low morale, and a lack of accountability within the organization.

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1.1.4 Imagine a World without CSW 😱

Impact on the Supervisor:

- ***"Supervisor ba ako o staff?"*** (Added load of work)
- ***"Ano bang klaseng trabaho/output ito?"*** (Lacks details and quality)
- ***"Naku, wala ng time! Ako na nga lang gagawa!"*** (Time management issue)
- ***"Sorry po, Mayor. Iyan lang nakaya ng team ko."*** (Lacks details and quality)
- ***"Napagalitan! Stressed! Gusto ng magresign."*** (Issue on emotional intelligence and accountability)
- *"(Galit din sa staff)* ***Hoy! Magtrabaho nga kayo! Ayusin nyo iyang trabaho ninyo! Napapahamak ako ng dahil sa inyo!"*** (Issue on emotional intelligence and accountability)

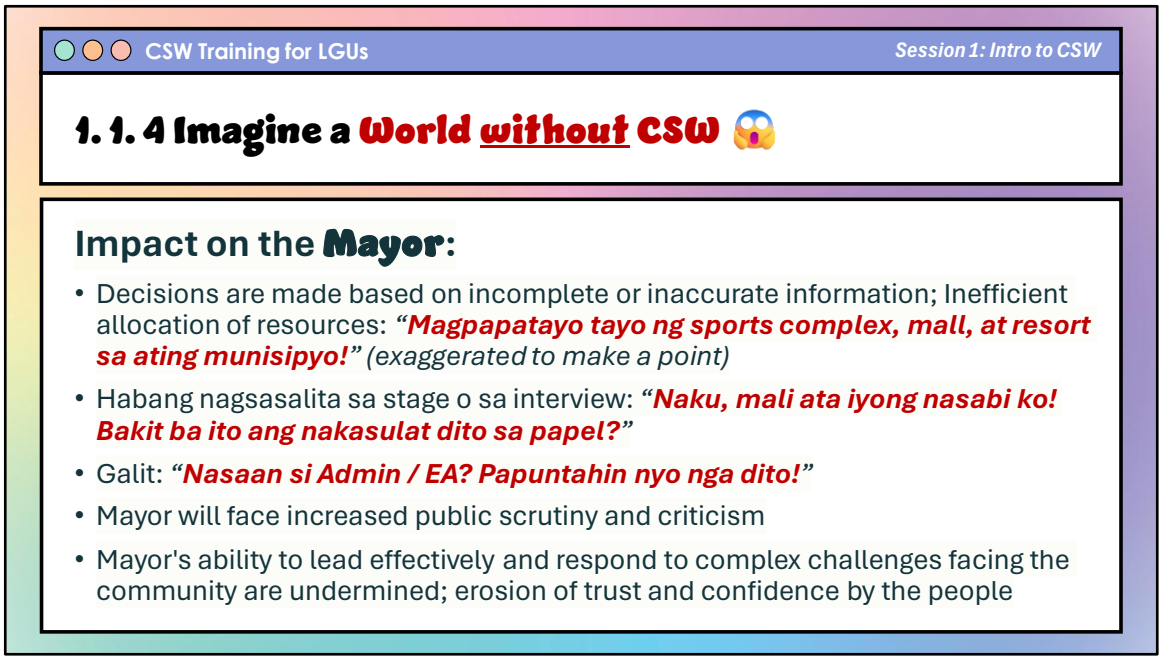
Impact on the Supervisor:

Supervisors would also face significant challenges in the absence of CSW, as they would be responsible for managing and coordinating staff work without a structured framework. Potential issues might include:

"Supervisor ba ako o staff?" (Added load of work)
"Ano bang klaseng trabaho/output ito?" (Lacks details and quality)
"Naku, wala ng time! Ako na nga lang gagawa!" (Time management issue)
"Sorry po, Mayor. Iyan lang nakaya ng team ko." (Lacks details and quality)
"Napagalitan! Stressed! Gusto ng magresign." (Issue on emotional intelligence and accountability)
"(Galit din sa staff) Hoy! Magtrabaho nga kayo! Ayusin nyo iyang trabaho ninyo! Napapahamak ako ng dahil sa inyo!" (Issue on emotional intelligence and accountability)

Without CSW, supervisors may struggle to manage their teams effectively, leading to poor quality work, missed deadlines, and strained relationships with staff and superiors. This could result in increased stress, burnout, and high

turnover rates among supervisors.



Impact on the Mayor:

The Mayor, as the chief executive of the municipality, would face significant challenges in making informed decisions and effectively leading the local government without the support of CSW. Potential issues might include:

Decisions are made based on incomplete or inaccurate information; Inefficient allocation of resources: "Magpapatayo tayo ng sports complex, mall, at resort sa ating munisipyo!" (exaggerated to make a point)
Habang nagsasalita sa stage o sa interview: "Naku, mali ata iyong nasabi ko! Bakit ba ito ang nakasulat dito sa papel?"
Galit: "Nasaan si Admin / EA? Papuntahin nyo nga dito!"

Without the thorough research, analysis, and recommendations provided by CSW, the Mayor may make decisions based on incomplete or inaccurate information, leading to inefficient allocation of resources and potentially costly mistakes. The Mayor's ability to lead effectively and respond to complex challenges facing the community would be undermined, and public trust and confidence in the local government could erode.

CSW Training for LGUs | Session 1: Intro to CSW

1.1.4 Imagine a World without CSW 😱

Impact on the People:

- *"Ano bang klaseng gobyerno ito!"* (Dissatisfied constituents)
- *"Mayor, hindi po kami nabigyan ng project/ayuda!"* (Resource allocation problem)
- *"Naku, dapat hindi ganun ang ginawa ni Mayor/ng LGU!"* (Decisions are made based on incomplete or inaccurate information)
- *"Ano ba ito? Puro na lang 'waiting shed' at 'building-building' ang pa-project! Hindi naman nagagamit! Wala na bang iba?"* (Lacks creativity and innovation; resource allocation problem)
- *"Sa susunod, iba na ang iboboto ko!"* (Dissatisfied constituents)

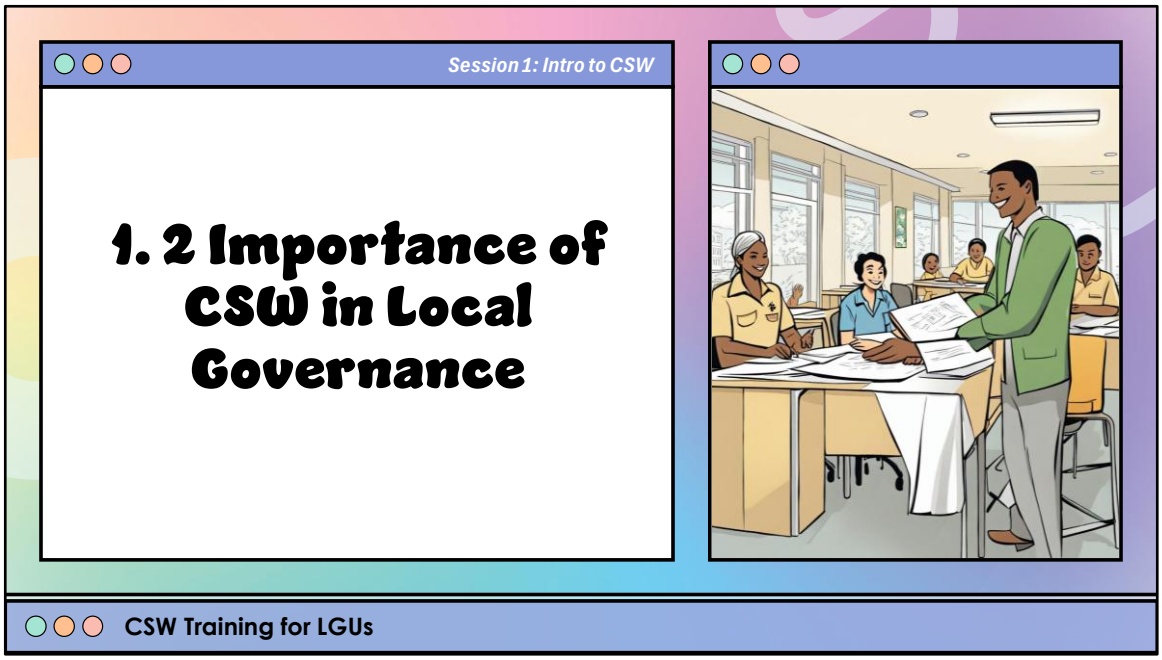
Impact on the People:
Ultimately, the people of Paglat would bear the brunt of the consequences of a local government operating without CSW. Potential issues might include:

"Ano bang klaseng gobyerno ito!" (Dissatisfied constituents)
"Mayor, hindi po kami nabigyan ng project/ayuda!" (Resource allocation problem)
"Naku, dapat hindi ganun ang ginawa ni Mayor/ng LGU!" (Decisions are made based on incomplete or inaccurate information)
"Ano ba ito? Puro na lang 'waiting shed' at 'building-building' ang pa-project! Wala na bang iba?" (Lacks creativity and innovation; resource allocation problem)
"Sa susunod, iba na ang iboboto ko!" (Dissatisfied constituents)

Without the systematic approach of CSW, the local government may fail to address the real needs of the community, leading to dissatisfaction, mistrust, and a potential loss of support from constituents. Resources may be allocated inefficiently, and projects or initiatives may lack creativity and innovation, failing to meet the evolving needs of the people.

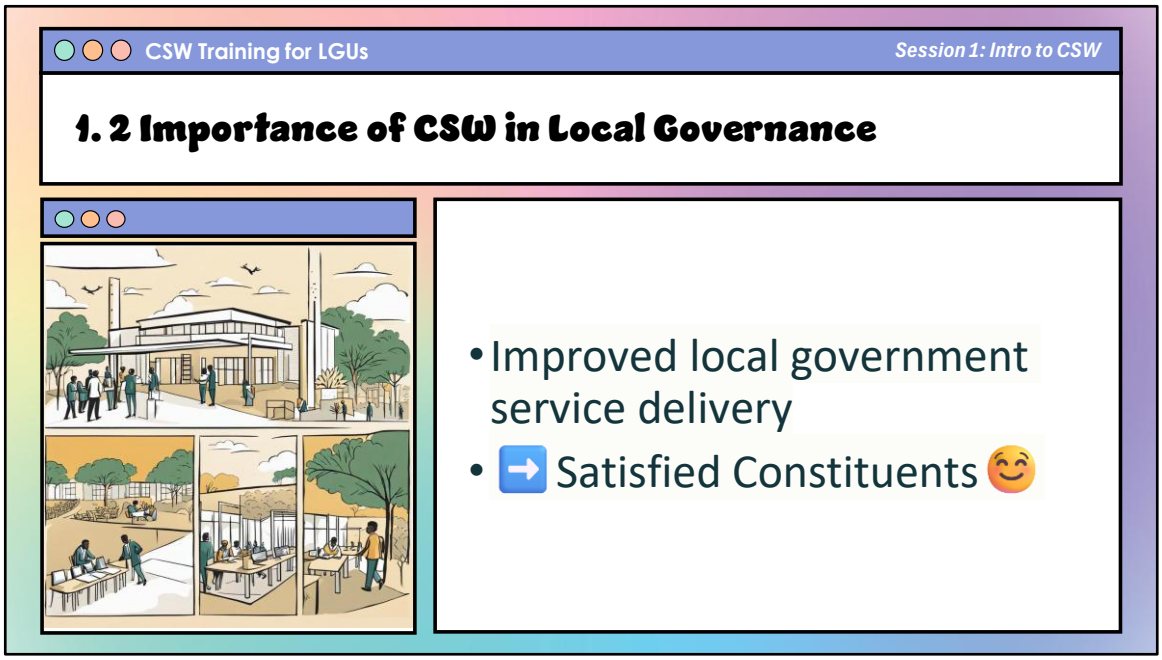
In a world without CSW, the Municipality of Paglat would face significant

challenges in delivering effective, responsive, and accountable governance. Staff, supervisors, and the Mayor would struggle to perform their duties effectively, leading to poor decision-making, inefficient resource allocation, and a lack of trust and confidence from the people they serve. The implementation of CSW is essential for ensuring that the local government operates in a systematic, evidence-based, and transparent manner, ultimately leading to better outcomes for the community.



1.2 Importance of CSW in Local Governance

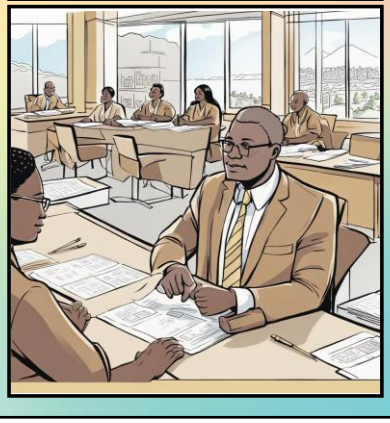
Implementing CSW in local governance brings numerous benefits that enhance the effectiveness, efficiency, and accountability of public service delivery. By adhering to the systematic approach of CSW, the Municipality of Paglat can improve outcomes for its constituents while promoting transparency and trust in the local government.



Improves Service Delivery and Constituent Satisfaction

One of the primary benefits of CSW is its ability to improve local government service delivery, leading to higher levels of constituent satisfaction. By thoroughly researching community needs, analyzing potential solutions, and developing well-reasoned recommendations, CSW helps ensure that policies, programs, and initiatives are tailored to address the real issues facing the people of Paglat. This targeted approach results in more effective and responsive services that meet the evolving needs of constituents.

1. 2 Importance of CSW in Local Governance



- Enhanced decision-making and problem solving
- Policies are research-backed and evidence-based

Enhances Decision-Making and Promotes Evidence-Based Policies

CSW enhances decision-making processes within local governance by providing a structured framework for comprehensive research, analysis, and the evaluation of options. Decisions made through the CSW process are grounded in evidence rather than assumptions or biases, leading to more informed and effective policies. This evidence-based approach helps to create targeted interventions that address root causes rather than merely treating symptoms.

1. 2 Importance of CSW in Local Governance

- Efficient allocation of public resources
- Improved coordination, collaboration, and coherence in governance

Ensures Efficient Allocation of Public Resources

By requiring staff to thoroughly analyze costs, benefits, and potential impacts, CSW supports effective resource allocation in local governance. Decision-makers can make informed choices about how to allocate limited public resources, ensuring that funds are directed towards the most cost-effective and impactful initiatives. This approach helps to maximize the impact of local government investments and improve outcomes for the community.

Facilitates Coordination, Collaboration, and Policy Coherence

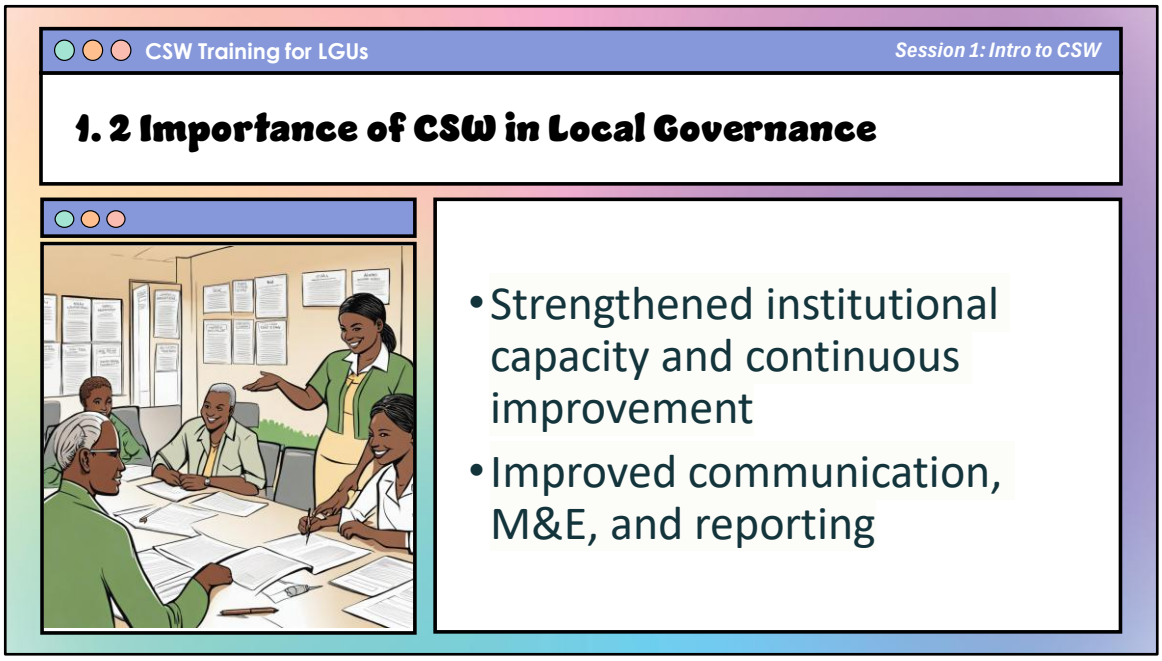
The CSW process facilitates collaboration and coordination among different departments and stakeholders within the local government. By involving relevant parties in the research and analysis phases, CSW encourages the sharing of information and perspectives, leading to a more comprehensive understanding of issues. This collaborative approach also helps to enhance policy coherence by identifying opportunities for synergy and avoiding potential conflicts or duplication of efforts.

1. 2 Importance of CSW in Local Governance

- Improved transparency, accountability, and stakeholder engagement

Promotes Transparency, Accountability, and Stakeholder Engagement

CSW enhances transparency and accountability in local governance by requiring staff to document their research, analysis, and decision-making processes. This documentation provides a clear record of how decisions were made and the rationale behind them, allowing for greater public scrutiny and accountability. Additionally, CSW enhances stakeholder engagement by requiring staff to consider the perspectives and interests of different groups in their research and analysis.



Strengthens Institutional Capacity and Continuous Improvement

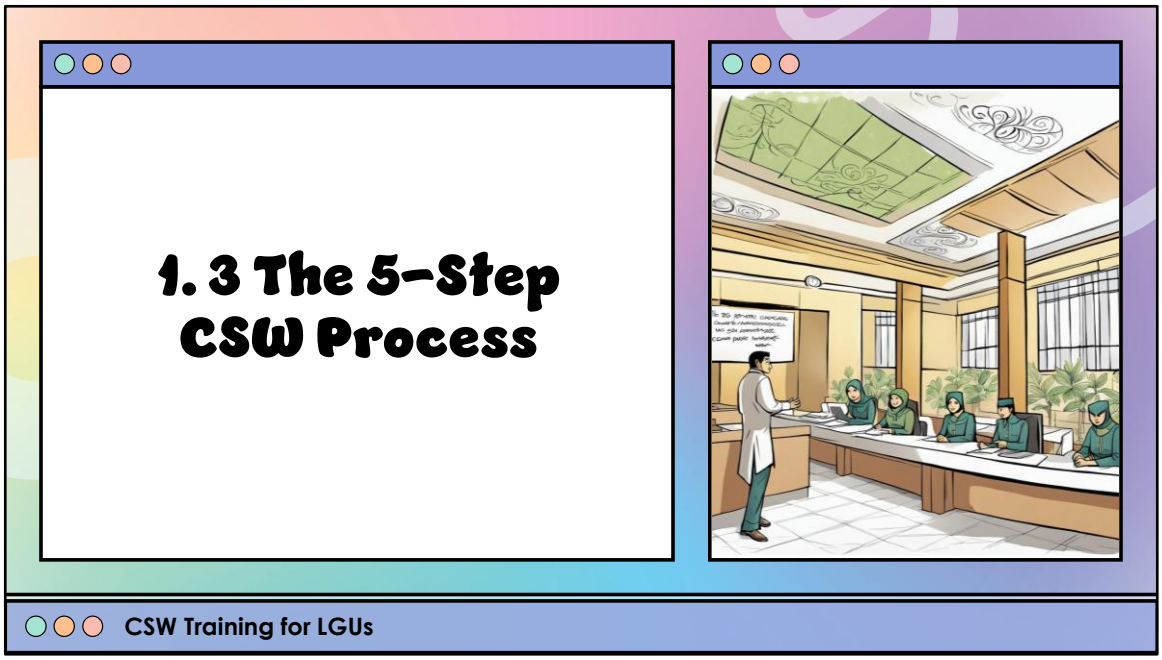
Implementing CSW in local governance helps to strengthen institutional capacity and promote a culture of continuous improvement. By requiring staff to engage in rigorous research, analysis, and problem-solving, CSW encourages the development of critical thinking skills and a more proactive approach to their work. The iterative nature of the CSW process also encourages staff to constantly seek ways to improve their work and the services they provide.

Improves Communication, Monitoring and Evaluation, and Reporting

CSW improves communication and reporting within local government by establishing clear standards for how information is presented and shared. The emphasis on clear, concise, and well-structured reports in CSW ensures that important information is effectively communicated to decision-makers and other stakeholders. Additionally, CSW improves monitoring and evaluation by establishing clear criteria for success and requiring staff to collect and analyze relevant data.

By embracing the principles and practices of Completed Staff Work, the Municipality

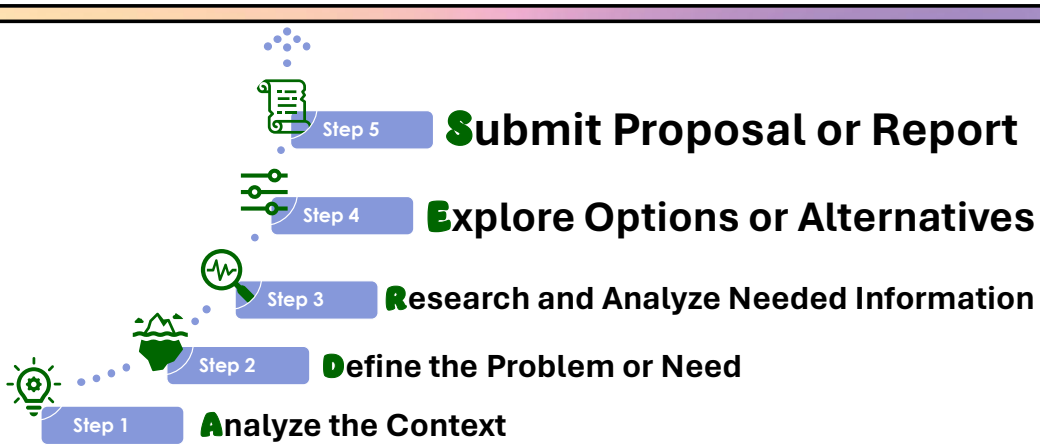
of Paglat can enhance the effectiveness, efficiency, and accountability of its local governance. From improving service delivery and decision-making to promoting transparency and stakeholder engagement, CSW offers a comprehensive approach to addressing the complex challenges facing the community.



1.3 The 5-Step CSW Process

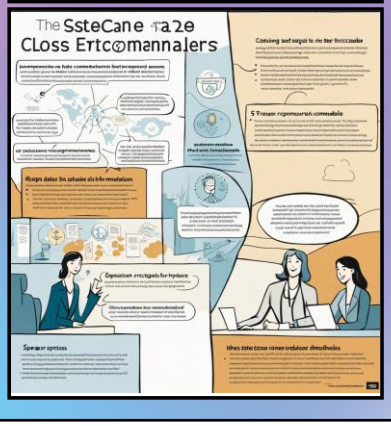
At the heart of Completed Staff Work is a systematic 5-step process that guides staff in developing comprehensive and actionable recommendations for decision-makers. This structured approach ensures that proposals are thoroughly researched, carefully analyzed, and effectively communicated.

1.3 The 5-Step CSW Process – ADRES



CSW Step 1: Analyze the Context

1. Identify the stakeholders who are involved in the decision-making process and their perspectives on the issue at hand
2. Consider any external factors such as legal, economic, social, or political issues that may impact the decision
3. Analyze any existing policies, guidelines, or regulations that may affect the decision-making process



Step 1: Define the Problem or Issue

The first step in the CSW process is to clearly define the problem or issue that needs to be addressed1. This involves gathering relevant background information, identifying key stakeholders, and developing a concise problem statement that captures the core challenge or opportunity.

During this stage, staff should ask probing questions to fully understand the context and scope of the issue1. Techniques like root cause analysis can be employed to identify underlying factors contributing to the problem.

Guide questions for CSW Step 1: Analyze the Context:

Identifying Stakeholders:

- Who are the key individuals, groups or organizations that have an interest in or will be impacted by decisions related to this issue?
- What are the different perspectives, interests and priorities of these stakeholders?
- Are there any potential conflicts or competing interests among stakeholders?
- How can we ensure all relevant stakeholder voices are heard and considered?

Assessing External Factors:

- What legal or regulatory requirements need to be considered for this issue?
- How might current economic conditions impact potential solutions?
- Are there any relevant social, cultural or demographic factors to account for?
- What political dynamics or sensitivities exist around this issue?

Reviewing Policies and Regulations:

- What existing policies, plans or strategies are relevant to this issue area?
- Do any national, regional or local laws/regulations constrain decision options?
- Are there gaps or inconsistencies in the current policy framework that need addressing?
- How well do current policies align with evidence, best practices or community needs?

CSW Step 2: Define the Problem or Need

1. Clearly define the problem or need by asking questions such as what, why, when, where, and how
2. Identify the root cause(s) of the problem or need
3. Consider the potential impact of the problem or need on the stakeholders involved

Step 2: Gather Relevant Information and Data

Once the problem has been defined, the next step is to gather all relevant information and data related to the issue1. This may involve conducting research, reviewing existing literature or reports, collecting data through surveys or interviews, and consulting subject matter experts.

It is crucial to cast a wide net and consider information from diverse sources and perspectives1. Staff should also critically evaluate the reliability and validity of the information they gather.

Guide questions for CSW Step 2: Define the Problem or Need:

Clearly Defining the Problem/Need:

- What is the specific problem or need being addressed?
- Why is this problem/need important to address? What are the consequences of not addressing it?
- When did this problem/need first arise or become apparent? Is it an ongoing or recurring issue?

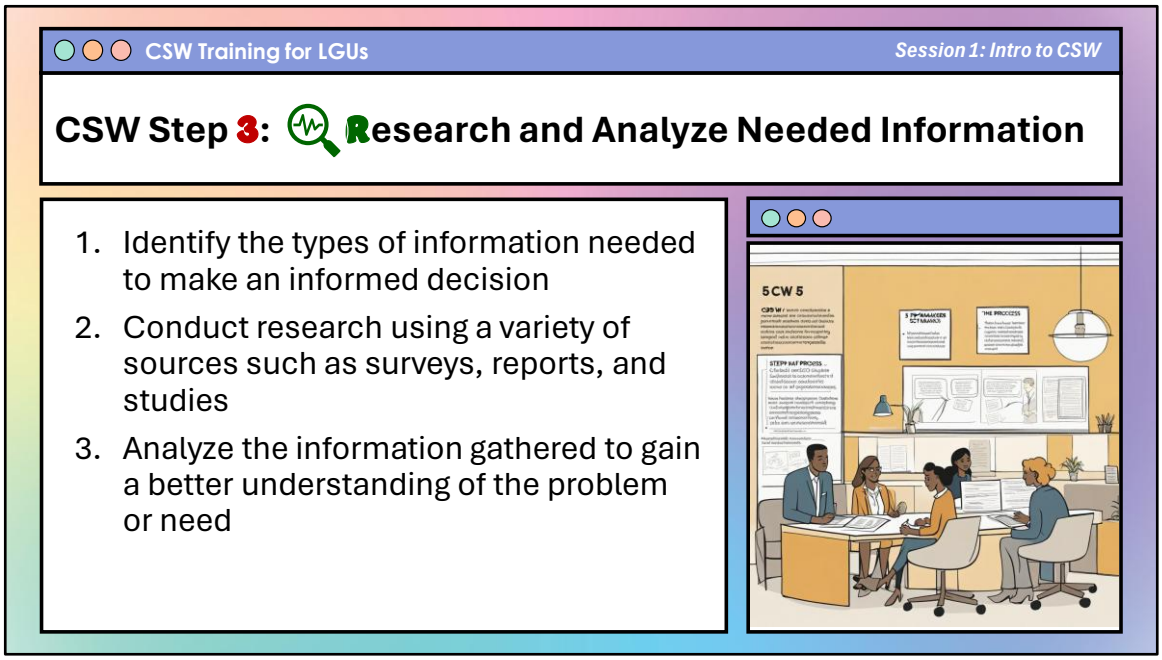
- Where is the problem/need most prevalent or concentrated (e.g. specific location, department, community)?
- How is the problem/need currently manifesting itself? What are the visible symptoms or effects?

Identifying Root Causes:

- What are the potential underlying causes contributing to this problem/need?
- Why do these root causes exist? What factors allow them to persist?
- Are there historical, cultural, or systemic issues enabling these root causes?
- How have previous attempts to address the problem/need failed to resolve the root causes?

Considering Potential Impacts:

- Who are the key stakeholders affected by this problem/need (e.g. citizens, businesses, government)?
- What are the potential economic, social, environmental or other impacts on these stakeholders?
- How might the impacts differ across different stakeholder groups or geographic areas?
- Are there potential unintended consequences that need to be considered?
- What would be the broader implications for local governance if this problem/need remains unaddressed?



Step 3: Analyze Information and Explore Options

With a comprehensive set of information and data, staff can then begin to analyze the issue in depth1. This involves identifying patterns, trends, and relationships within the data, as well as exploring potential root causes and contributing factors.

During this stage, staff should also explore various options or courses of action that could address the problem1. This may involve benchmarking best practices, conducting cost-benefit analyses, or using decision-making tools like decision trees or scenario planning.

Guide questions for CSW Step 3: Research and Analyze Needed Information:

Identifying Types of Information Needed:

- What specific information is required to fully understand the problem or need?
- What quantitative data (statistics, metrics, etc.) would provide insights?
- What qualitative information (opinions, experiences, etc.) is needed for context?
- Are there any knowledge gaps that require additional research?

- What baseline data exists related to the current state of the issue?

Conducting Research from Various Sources:
- What existing reports, studies or data sources are relevant to this issue?
- Would a survey help gather needed perspectives from stakeholders?
- Which subject matter experts or community members could provide valuable input?
- Are there comparable situations or best practices from other municipalities to learn from?
- What site visits, observations or public records could shed light on the issue?

Analyzing the Information:
- How can the quantitative data be statistically analyzed to identify trends or correlations?
- What themes or insights emerge from reviewing the qualitative information?
- How does the information align with or contradict initial assumptions about the issue?
- Are there any conflicting perspectives or contradictory data that need reconciling?
- What are the key takeaways that should guide decision-making on this issue?

CSW Step 4: Explore Options or Alternatives

1. Generate a list of potential solutions to the problem or need
2. Evaluate the potential solutions by considering their feasibility, effectiveness, and sustainability
3. Identify potential allies and opposition for each solution option and assess their potential impact on the decision-making process

Step 4: Develop Recommendations and Proposed Course of Action

Based on the analysis conducted in the previous step, staff can then develop specific recommendations and a proposed course of action1. This should include a clear statement of the recommended solution, along with a detailed implementation plan that outlines the necessary steps, resources, timelines, and potential risks or challenges.

The recommendations should be actionable, feasible, and aligned with the organization's goals and objectives1. Staff should also consider potential unintended consequences and develop contingency plans or mitigation strategies.

Guide questions for exploring options or alternatives in Step 4 of the Completed Staff Work (CSW) process:

Generating a List of Potential Solutions:

- What are all the possible ways we could address this problem or need?
- Are there any creative or unconventional solutions we should consider?

- What solutions have worked for similar issues in other municipalities or organizations?
- How can we build on existing strengths, resources or initiatives?
- Are there opportunities to prevent the problem from recurring rather than just treating the symptoms?

Evaluating Feasibility, Effectiveness and Sustainability:

Feasibility:
- What resources (financial, human, technical) would be required to implement this solution?
- How does the solution align with existing policies, regulations or organizational priorities?
- What potential barriers or risks need to be addressed for successful implementation?

Effectiveness:
- How well does this solution address the root causes of the problem?
- What evidence or data supports the potential impact of this approach?
- How can we measure and evaluate whether the solution is achieving its intended outcomes?

Sustainability:
- What are the potential long-term costs or consequences of this solution?
- How easily can the solution be scaled up or replicated if successful?
- What ongoing resources or support would be needed to sustain the solution over time?

Identifying Allies and Opposition:

- Who are the key stakeholders that may be impacted by or have an interest in this solution?
- Which stakeholders are likely to support or oppose this approach, and why?
- How influential are the potential allies and opponents? What is their ability to impact decision-making?
- Are there ways to address the concerns of potential opponents to build broader support?
- How can we leverage the strengths and resources of allies to increase chances of successful implementation?

CSW Step 5: Submit Proposal or Report

1. Prepare a written proposal or report that includes the problem or need, the solution, and the decision-making process
2. Present the proposal or report to the Municipal Mayor, who will evaluate and approve the document and propose it as a policy measure to be adopted by the Sangguniang Bayan, if it requires an ordinance or the concurrence of the latter
3. Obtain feedback and revise the proposal or report as needed

Step 5: Present Proposal to Decision-Makers

The final step in the CSW process is to present the comprehensive proposal to decision-makers for their review and approval1. This typically involves preparing a well-structured report or presentation that clearly communicates the problem, analysis, and recommended course of action.

During the presentation, staff should be prepared to answer questions, address concerns, and provide additional context or clarification as needed1. It is also important to highlight the potential benefits and risks associated with the proposed solution, as well as any alternative options that were considered.

Guide questions for CSW Step 5: Submit Proposal or Report:

Preparing the Written Proposal/Report:

- Have all the key components been included (problem statement, context analysis, research findings, proposed solution, implementation plan, etc.)?
- Is the language clear, concise, and free of jargon or technical terms that may be unfamiliar to the intended audience?

- Are all claims and recommendations supported by evidence from the research and analysis conducted?
- Have all relevant policies, regulations, and stakeholder perspectives been considered and addressed?
- Is the proposal/report well-structured, with a logical flow and clear section headings?
- Have any potential risks, challenges, or unintended consequences been identified and mitigated?

Presenting to the Municipal Mayor:

- How can the key points and recommendations be effectively summarized for the Mayor's review?
- What visual aids or presentation materials would help to clearly communicate the proposal/report?
- How can the presentation be tailored to address the Mayor's specific concerns or priorities?
- What potential questions or objections from the Mayor should be anticipated and addressed?
- How can the benefits and impact of the proposed solution be effectively highlighted?

Obtaining Feedback and Revising:

- What mechanisms will be in place to gather feedback from the Mayor, other officials, and relevant stakeholders?
- How will this feedback be systematically reviewed and incorporated into revisions?
- Are there any areas of the proposal/report that may require additional research or analysis based on the feedback received?
- How can the revised proposal/report be effectively communicated and disseminated to ensure transparency and accountability?
- What is the process for obtaining final approval and adoption of the proposal/report as a policy measure?

If Requiring Sangguniang Bayan Approval:

- What specific ordinances, resolutions, or actions are required from the Sangguniang Bayan?
- How can the proposal/report be presented to the Sangguniang Bayan in a clear and compelling manner?
- What potential concerns or objections from the Sangguniang Bayan members should be anticipated and addressed?
- How can support and buy-in from the Sangguniang Bayan be effectively secured?
- What is the process for incorporating any revisions or amendments requested by the Sangguniang Bayan?

Continuous Improvement and Feedback Loop

While the 5-step process provides a structured framework, it is important to recognize that CSW is an iterative and continuous process. After a decision has been made and the proposed solution has been implemented, staff should monitor the outcomes and gather feedback from stakeholders.

This feedback can then be used to refine the approach, identify areas for improvement, and inform future decision-making processes. By embracing a culture of continuous learning and improvement, organizations can enhance the effectiveness of their CSW practices over time.

SURVEY

SURVEY

How are you implementing the steps of the CSW process?

10 min

SESSION 2

Importance of CSW in Local Governance

Session 2

THE IMPORTANCE OF CSW IN LOCAL GOVERNANCE

- Role of CSW in Effective and Good Local Governance
- Benefits, Challenges, and Strategies of Implementing CSW

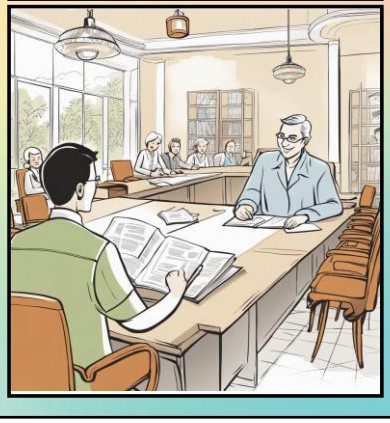
2.1 Role of CSW in Effective and Good Local Governance

2.1.1 Strategic and Operations Planning

- Improved alignment of plans with the needs and priorities of the constituents
- Increased effectiveness and efficiency in the implementation of plans
- Better coordination and collaboration among the different departments and units of the local government

The CSW process can be applied to the development of strategic and operations plans for the municipality. By following the ***5-step process (ADRES),*** the municipal officials and staff can ensure that the plans are based on a thorough analysis of the *context*, *needs*, and *priorities of the constituents*, and are aligned with the *vision*, *mission*, and *goals* of the local government.

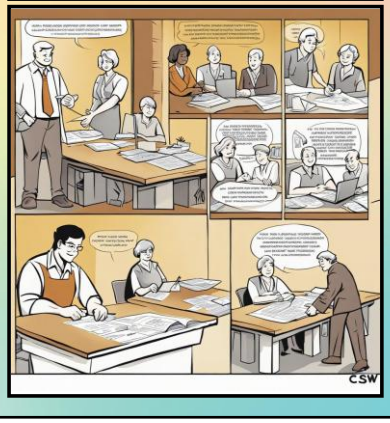
2. 1. 2 Policy Development and Legislation



- Improved quality and effectiveness of policies and legislation
- Increased transparency and accountability in the policy-making process
- Better alignment with the needs and concerns of the constituents

The CSW process can be used to develop and propose policies, ordinances, and resolutions that address the needs and concerns of the constituents. By following the 5-step process (ADRES), the municipal officials and staff can ensure that the proposed policies are well-researched, evidence-based, and aligned with the priorities of the local government.

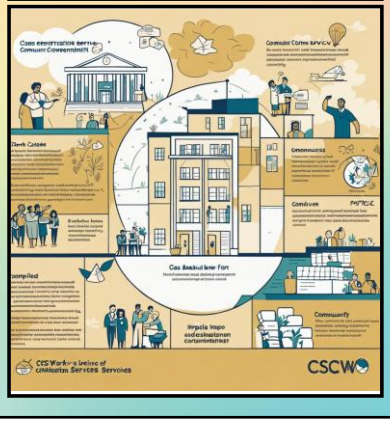
2.1.3 Project and Program Management



- Improved project and program outcomes
- Increased efficiency and effectiveness in resource allocation
- Better alignment with the strategic goals and objectives of the local government

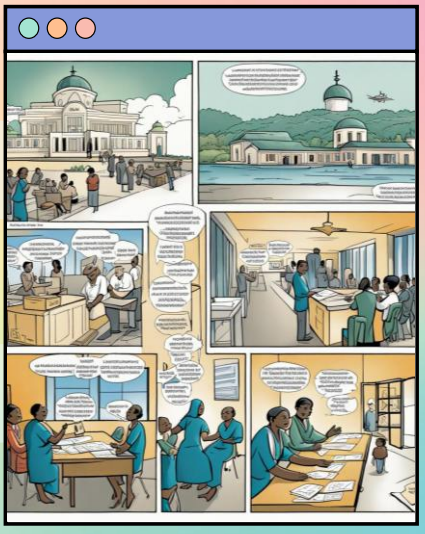
The CSW framework can be applied to the *planning*, *implementation*, and *evaluation* of projects and programs of the local government. By analyzing the context, defining the problem or need, researching and analyzing needed information, exploring options, and submitting a proposal or report, the municipal officials and staff can ensure that the projects and programs are feasible, effective, and sustainable.

2. 1. 4 Delivery of Basic Services



- Improved access to and quality of basic services for the constituents
- Increased satisfaction and trust of the constituents in the local government
- Better use of resources and funds in the delivery of basic services

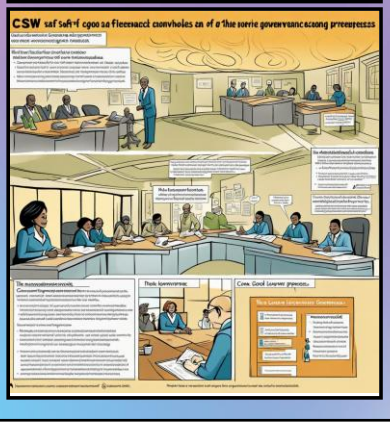
The CSW process can be applied to the planning, implementation, and evaluation of basic services such as health, education, social welfare, and infrastructure. By following the 5-step process, the municipal officials and staff can ensure that the services are responsive to the needs of the constituents, are of high quality, and are delivered in an efficient and effective manner.



2.2 CSW and SGLG Compliance

2.2.1 Financial Administration and Sustainability

The CSW process is highly valuable in developing and proposing policies, ordinances, and resolutions related to fiscal discipline, transparency, and accountability in the use of public funds.



By following the systematic 5-step ADRES process, municipal officials and staff can ensure that proposed measures are thoroughly researched, evidence-based, and aligned with the LGU's priorities and fiscal sustainability goals.

The first step of analyzing the context allows officials to consider legal requirements, budget constraints, and stakeholder concerns in financial management. Defining the problem in the second step helps pinpoint specific financial issues like revenue generation gaps or spending inefficiencies. Researching best practices, gathering financial data, and analyzing fiscal trends in the third step provides a solid basis for policy development. Exploring options in the fourth step enables the development of sound financial solutions. Finally, submitting a comprehensive, well-justified proposal in the fifth step increases the chances of adopting effective financial management reforms

2.2.2 Disaster Preparedness

The CSW framework is instrumental in planning, implementing, and evaluating comprehensive disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) plans and programs.

By meticulously following the 5-step process, LGU officials and staff can develop highly effective, evidence-based, and context-specific DRRM measures that strengthen the LGU's resilience against natural and human-induced hazards.

Analyzing the disaster risk context in the first step, including *hazard profile*, *vulnerabilities* and *capacities*, informs responsive DRRM planning. Defining specific DRRM issues and gaps in the second step, such as inadequate early warning or lack of trained responders, paves the way for targeted interventions. Researching on best practices, conducting risk assessments, and analyzing DRRM resources in the third step provides a robust basis for designing DRRM programs. Exploring viable, effective and sustainable DRRM strategies in the fourth step leads to innovative solutions. Lastly, submitting a well-crafted DRRM plan with clear activities, timelines, budgets and monitoring measures in the fifth step facilitates implementation and increases impact

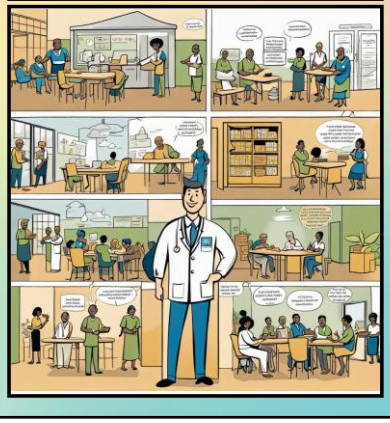
2.2.3 Social Protection and Sensitivity

CSW can significantly facilitate the development of responsive policies and programs that address the needs of vulnerable and marginalized sectors such as women, children, persons with disabilities, senior citizens, and indigenous peoples.

Following the systematic 5-step process enables LGU officials to actively engage stakeholders, identify root causes of social issues, explore inclusive solutions, and propose well-informed interventions that leave no one behind.

Analyzing the situation of vulnerable sectors, existing services, and relevant policies in the first step ensures a comprehensive understanding of social protection issues. Defining specific problems like access barriers to social services or marginalization in the second step enables targeted program design. Researching best practices, gathering disaggregated data, and analyzing social protection gaps in the third step informs evidence-based planning. Exploring viable, inclusive and empowering strategies in the fourth step leads to responsive programs. Submitting a well-designed social protection proposal with clear objectives, activities, budgets and safeguards in the fifth step promotes effective implementation

2. 2. 4 Health Compliance and Responsiveness



Applying the CSW process to health policy development and program planning can significantly improve the LGU's capacity to establish an integrated healthcare delivery system that equitably promotes public health and well-being, especially for the vulnerable.

The thorough stakeholder engagement, situational analysis, research, options exploration, and proposal development involved in the 5-step process results in highly responsive, evidence-based health initiatives.

Analyzing the health situation, service delivery network, and policy landscape in the first step provides a comprehensive context for health planning. Defining specific health systems gaps and challenges like lack of access to primary care in the second step enables focused interventions. Researching on health financing, service delivery models, and analyzing local health data in the third step informs evidence-based program design. Exploring feasible, effective and equitable health solutions in the fourth step leads to people-centered approaches. Submitting a well-crafted health plan with clear objectives, strategies, budgets, and monitoring and evaluation framework in the fifth step facilitates implementation and strengthens accountability

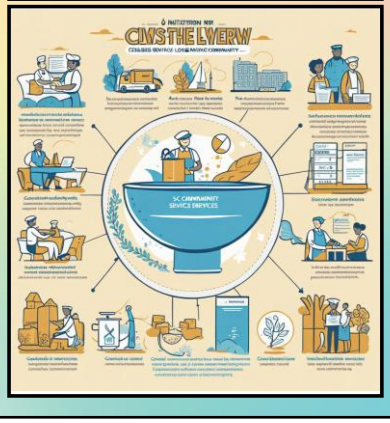
2.2.5 Sustainable Education

The CSW framework can strategically guide LGUs in planning, implementing, and monitoring education reforms and programs that support accessible and quality education for all.

By rigorously following the 5-step process, LGU officials can develop well-informed, effective, and inclusive education policies and interventions that are responsive to local needs and aligned with national education goals.

Analyzing the education context, including access, quality, and governance issues in the first step, provides a system-wide perspective for planning. Defining specific education challenges like high dropout rates or lack of learning materials in the second step enables targeted reforms. Researching education best practices, gathering disaggregated data, and analyzing resource gaps in the third step informs evidence-based program design. Exploring context-specific, innovative and gender-responsive strategies in the fourth step leads to transformative education initiatives. Submitting a comprehensive education plan with clear objectives, budgets, activities, and key performance indicators in the fifth step promotes effective implementation and monitoring

2.2.6 Business-Friendliness and Competitiveness



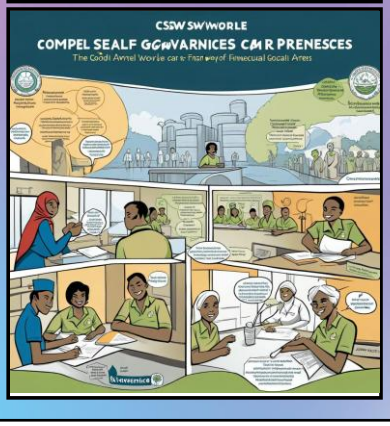
Utilizing CSW in formulating business-related policies, programs and services can enable pro-competitive measures, ease of doing business, and local economic development, in line with national laws and standards.

The systematic 5-step process of analyzing the business environment, defining specific bottlenecks, researching best practices, exploring viable solutions, and developing comprehensive proposals leads to sound, well-researched policies that improve the business climate and competitiveness.

Analyzing the business context, including economic profile, growth drivers, and investment policies in the first step provides a solid basis for business-friendly reforms. Defining specific challenges like red tape in business registration or lack of market linkages in the second step enables focused interventions. Researching on business process improvements, incentives, and value chain development in the third step informs evidence-based policies. Exploring streamlined, innovative and sustainable strategies in the fourth step leads to game-changing programs. Submitting a well-designed business competitiveness plan with clear action points, success indicators, and public-private partnership mechanisms in the fifth step facilitates effective execution

2.2.7 Safety, Peace and Order

CSW can be strategically applied in developing responsive public safety and security plans and programs to better protect constituents from crime and violence.



Rigorously following the 5-step process of conducting a thorough context analysis, defining specific peace and order issues, exploring evidence-based solutions, and crafting comprehensive proposals results in highly responsive, context-specific crime prevention measures.

Analyzing crime statistics, security risks, and existing public safety mechanisms in the first step provides a comprehensive context for planning. Defining specific peace and order problems like proliferation of illegal drugs or weak community relations in the second step enables targeted interventions. Researching on crime prevention models, gathering community feedback, and analyzing resource needs in the third step informs evidence-based program design. Exploring community-based, multi-stakeholder and sustainable strategies in the fourth step leads to holistic approaches. Submitting a well-crafted public safety plan with clear objectives, budgets, activities, and monitoring and evaluation scheme in the fifth step promotes effective implementation and public trust

2.2.8 Environmental Management

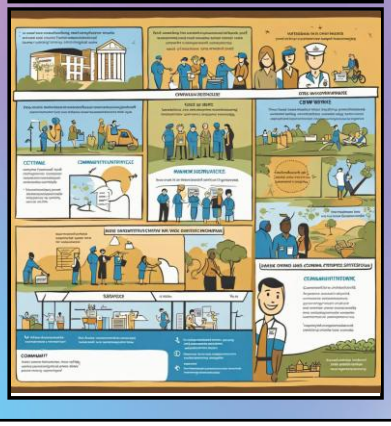
The CSW process can strategically guide the formulation of policies and programs that safeguard and preserve the environment and natural resources.

Meticulously following the 5-step process of stakeholder engagement, situational analysis, research, options analysis, and program development enables LGUs to identify critical environmental issues, explore sustainable solutions, and implement well-designed interventions.

Analyzing the ecological profile, environmental risks, and relevant policies in the first step provides a comprehensive context for planning. Defining specific environmental challenges like biodiversity loss or lack of waste management in the second step enables targeted programs. Researching on environmental protection models, conducting resource assessments, and analyzing best practices in the third step informs evidence-based policies. Exploring eco-friendly, community-based and innovative strategies in the fourth step leads to sustainable solutions. Submitting a comprehensive environmental management plan with clear goals, budgets, partnerships, and sustainability mechanisms in the fifth step facilitates effective implementation and monitoring

2.2.9 Tourism, Heritage Development, Culture and Arts

Applying CSW in tourism and cultural heritage policy development and promotion planning can significantly boost LGU efforts in nurturing sustainable tourism, enriching cultural vitality, and spurring local economic growth.



The thorough stakeholder engagement, situational analysis, benchmarking, options exploration, and program packaging involved in the 5-step process results in highly responsive, evidence-based, and marketable initiatives that showcase the best of the locality.

Analyzing the tourism and cultural assets, market trends, and existing programs in the first step provides a comprehensive context for planning. Defining specific challenges like lack of infrastructure or weak branding in the second step enables focused interventions. Researching on tourism development models, conducting market analysis, and gathering stakeholder inputs in the third step informs evidence-based strategies. Exploring innovative, sustainable and inclusive tourism and cultural promotion approaches in the fourth step leads to differentiated offerings. Submitting a well-packaged tourism and cultural development plan with clear branding, products, budgets, and destination management scheme in the fifth step facilitates effective marketing and implementation

2.2.10 Youth Development

The CSW framework can be highly valuable in developing and implementing youth-focused policies and programs that promote meaningful youth participation in local governance and community development.

By systematically following the 5-step process, LGUs can formulate responsive, evidence-based and empowering youth development initiatives that harness the full potential of the youth as partners in nation-building.

Analyzing the situation of the youth, existing youth programs, and relevant policies in the first step provides a comprehensive context for planning. Defining specific youth development issues like lack of opportunities or risky behaviors in the second step enables targeted interventions. Researching on youth empowerment models, gathering disaggregated data on the youth, and analyzing good practices in the third step informs evidence-based program design. Exploring youth-led, gender-responsive and inclusive strategies in the fourth step leads to transformative initiatives. Submitting a comprehensive youth development plan with clear objectives, budgets, activities, and youth engagement mechanisms in the fifth step promotes effective implementation and sustainability

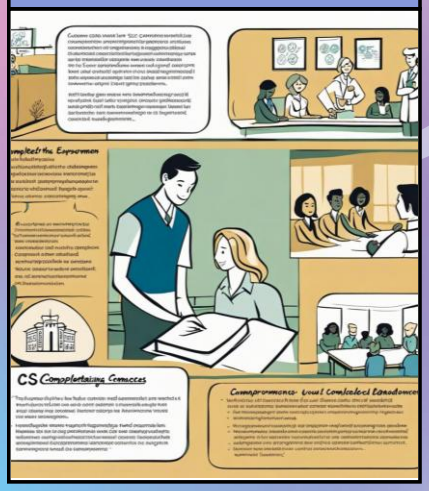
WORKSHOP

WORKSHOP

Status, Benefits, Challenges, and Strategies of Implementing CSW in Paglat

20-30 min brainstorming; 45-60 min discussions

2.3.1 STATUS of CSW in your department / team and in the LGU as a whole



2.3.1 STATUS of Implementing CSW

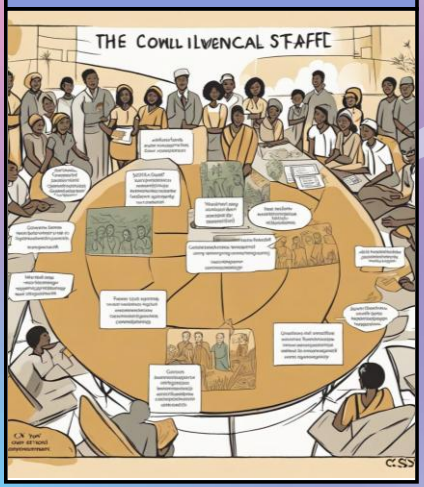
What is the current status of implementing the Completed Staff Work (CSW) framework in the Municipality of Paglat? To what extent is it being utilized across different departments and processes? Are there specific examples or use cases where CSW has been effectively applied in developing policies, plans or programs in Paglat?

2.3.2 BENEFITS of Implementing CSW in your department / team

2.3.1 BENEFITS of Implementing CSW

What are the key benefits that the municipal government and community have experienced or expect to experience from consistently implementing CSW?

2.3.3 CHALLENGES of Implementing CSW in your department / team



2.3.3 CHALLENGES of Implementing CSW

What challenges or barriers has the municipality faced in trying to implement and institutionalize the CSW process across different governance areas?

2.2.3 STRATEGIES in Implementing CSW in your department / team

2. 3. 4 STRATEGIES of Implementing CSW

What strategies or approaches could be employed to more effectively implement CSW and build the capacity of municipal officials and staff in utilizing this framework?

CSW Strategy Questions

1. How can the systematic 5-step CSW process (Analyze, Define, Research, Explore, Submit) lead to more evidence-based, responsive and sustainable policies, plans and programs in Paglat?
2. What governance structures, systems or mechanisms need to be established or strengthened to support and institutionalize CSW implementation in the municipality?
3. How can CSW be integrated into the various planning, budgeting and decision-making processes of the local government across the different governance areas?
4. What capacity building interventions (training, coaching, tools) are needed to enhance the CSW skills and competencies of municipal officials and staff?

CSW Strategy Questions

5. How can local governance bodies like the Sangguniang Bayan, development councils, and sectoral committees be engaged to promote and oversee CSW implementation?
6. What monitoring and evaluation mechanisms can be put in place to track the utilization of CSW and assess its impact on the quality of local governance in Paglat?
7. How can CSW implementation in Paglat be aligned with and contribute to the municipality's goals of adhering to Islamic principles and achieving the SGLG criteria?
8. What role can different stakeholders (civil society, private sector, community members) play in promoting and supporting the adoption of CSW in local governance processes?

SESSION 3

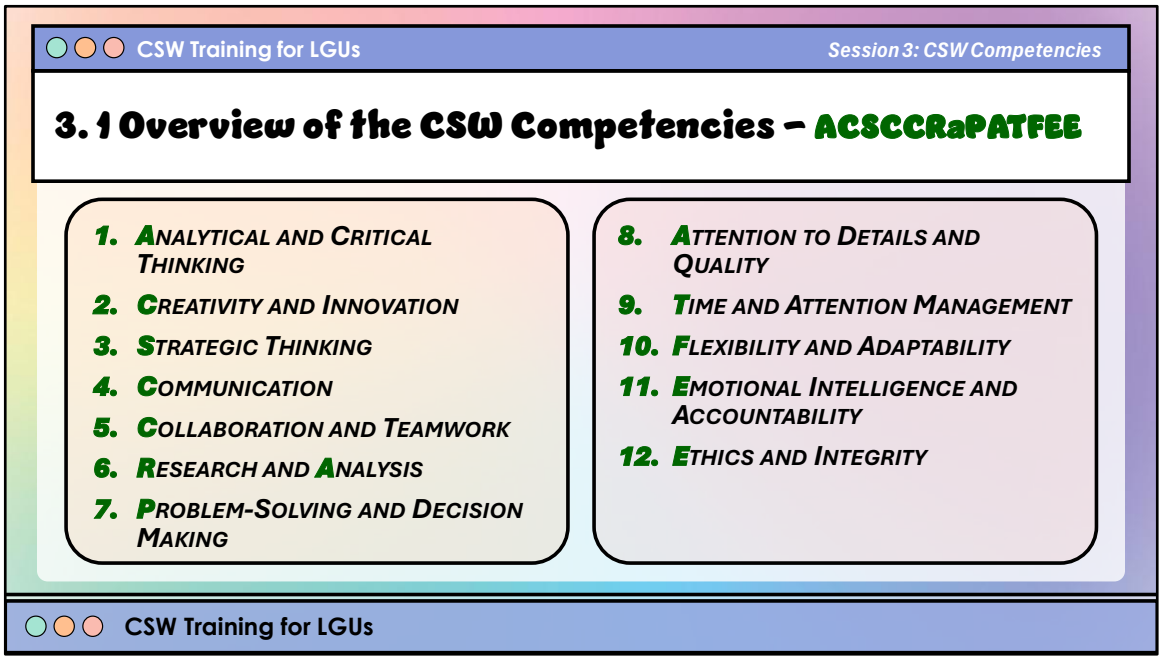
Competencies of CSW Practitioners

Session 3

COMPETENCIES OF CSW PRACTITIONERS

- Overview of the CSW Competencies
- Self-Assessment on CSW Competencies
- Action Planning on Strengthening CSW Competencies

3.1 Overview of CSW Competencies



1. ***Analytical and Critical Thinking***: The ability to evaluate information and data to make informed decisions.
2. ***Creativity and Innovation***: The ability to generate new and unique ideas and solutions to problems.
3. ***Strategic Thinking***: The ability to anticipate and plan for the future to achieve organizational goals.
4. ***Communication***: The ability to effectively convey information and ideas to others.
5. ***Collaboration and Teamwork***: The ability to work effectively with others towards a common goal.

6. ***Research and Analysis***: The ability to gather and analyze information to inform decision making and problem solving.
7. ***Problem-Solving and Decision Making***: The ability to identify and address problems and make informed decisions.
8. ***Attention to Details and Quality***: The ability to perform work accurately and thoroughly, with a focus on quality.
9. ***Time and Attention Management***: The ability to manage time effectively and focus attention on tasks to maximize productivity.
10. ***Flexibility and Adaptability***: The ability to adjust to new and changing situations and demands.
11. ***Emotional Intelligence and Accountability***: The ability to understand and manage one's emotions and take responsibility for one's actions.
12. ***Ethics and Integrity***: The adherence to moral and ethical principles and values in behavior and decision making.

3. 1. 1 Analytical and Critical Thinking

- **The ability to evaluate information and data objectively to identify patterns, draw logical conclusions, and make informed decisions.**

  Example: *A municipal planning officer uses analytical and critical thinking to review data on population growth, economic trends, and infrastructure needs. They identify patterns and draw insights to develop a comprehensive development plan for the municipality.*

Ang Analytical and Critical Thinking ay ang kakayahan kung saan ang mga pinagmulan ng mga impormasyon at data ay masusing sinusuri upang makagawa o makapagbigay ng logical na conclusion at makapagdesisyon batay sa nakuhang impormasyon na walang kinakampihan o walang bias na nangyayari

3. 1. 2 Creativity and Innovation

- **The ability to generate novel and unique ideas, solutions, and approaches to address challenges or improve existing processes.**

Example: *A social welfare officer uses creativity to develop an innovative program that provides skills training and livelihood opportunities for marginalized youth, addressing unemployment and social issues in the community.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang lumikha ng bago at natatanging ideya, solusyon, at pamamaraan upang harapin ang mga hamon o pahusayin ang kasalukuyang mga proseso.

3.1.3 Strategic Thinking

- **The ability to analyze complex situations, anticipate future trends and challenges, and develop long-term plans and strategies aligned with organizational goals.**

  Example: *The municipal administrator uses strategic thinking to assess the municipality's economic potential, identify growth opportunities, and develop a 10-year economic development plan that leverages local resources and attracts investments.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang masusing araling ang kumplekadong sitwasyon, mangunang makabatid ng mga hinaharap na trend at hamon, at bumuo ng matagalang plano at estratehiya na nakatugma sa mga layunin ng organisasyon.

3.1.4 Communication

- **The ability to convey information and ideas clearly, concisely, and effectively through various means, such as written reports, presentations, and interpersonal interactions.**

  Example: *A public information officer uses effective communication skills to disseminate updates and announcements from the local government through various channels, ensuring that information reaches all constituents in a clear and understandable manner.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang maipahayag ang impormasyon at ideya nang malinaw, makabuluhan, at epektibo sa pamamagitan ng iba't ibang paraan, tulad ng nakasulat na ulat, presentasyon, at pakikipag-ugnayan sa kapwa.

3.1.5 Collaboration and Teamwork

- **The ability to work cooperatively with others, build positive relationships, and contribute to a cohesive and productive team environment.**

  Example: *The municipal agriculture officer collaborates with farmer cooperatives, private sector partners, and other stakeholders to develop and implement sustainable agricultural programs that benefit the local farming community.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang magtulungan at makipagtrabaho sa iba, magbuo ng positibong relasyon, at maging bahagi ng isang nakabuklod at produktibong kooperatibang kapaligiran.

3.1.6 Research and Analysis

- **The ability to gather, evaluate, and synthesize information from various sources to gain insights, identify patterns, and support decision-making processes.**

  Example: *A municipal budget officer conducts thorough research and analysis of revenue streams, expenditures, and financial projections to develop a fiscally responsible and sustainable annual budget for the local government unit.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang makalap, masuri, at masundan ang impormasyon mula sa iba't ibang mapagkukunan upang makakuha ng kaalaman, matukoy ang mga pattern, at sumuporta sa proseso ng pagdedesisyon.

3.1.7 Problem-solving and Decision Making

- **The ability to identify and define problems, gather relevant information, evaluate alternatives, and make sound decisions that address issues effectively.**

Example: *The municipal disaster risk reduction officer uses problem-solving and decision-making skills to assess potential hazards, develop contingency plans, and make timely decisions during emergency situations to protect the community and minimize the impact of disasters.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang matukoy at mabigyang kahulugan ang mga problema, makalap ang kaukulang impormasyon, masuri ang mga alternatibo, at gumawa ng matatalinong desisyon na epektibong nalulutas ang mga isyu.

3.1.8 Attention to Details and Quality

- **The ability to perform work accurately, thoroughly, and with a high level of attention to detail, ensuring that outputs meet quality standards.**

Example: *A municipal engineer ensures attention to detail and quality in the construction of public infrastructure projects, meticulously reviewing plans, specifications, and on-site work to ensure compliance with building codes and safety standards.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang gampanan ang trabaho nang tumpak, masusi, at may mataas na antas ng pansin sa detalye, tinitiyak na ang mga output ay sumususog sa pamantayan ng kalidad.

3.1.9 Time and Attention Management

- **The ability to prioritize tasks, allocate time and resources effectively, and maintain focus on important goals and objectives.**

Example: *The municipal human resource officer uses time and attention management skills to coordinate recruitment processes, employee training programs, and personnel records management, ensuring that all tasks are completed efficiently and on schedule.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang magbigay ng prayoridad sa mga gawain, maepisyenteng maipamahagi ang oras at mapagkukunan, at mapanatili ang pokus sa mga mahalagang layunin at objektibo.

3. 1. 10 Flexibility and Adaptability

- **The ability to adjust to changing circumstances, embrace new ideas and approaches, and adapt to evolving situations and demands.**

Example: *A municipal health officer demonstrates flexibility and adaptability by quickly adjusting public health programs and protocols in response to emerging health threats or changing community needs, ensuring that the local government's response remains relevant and effective.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang umakma sa nagbabagong kalagayan, tanggapin ang mga bagong ideya at pamamaraan, at mabilis na makibagay sa mga nagbabagong sitwasyon at kahilingan.

3. 1. 11 Emotional Intelligence and Accountability

- **The ability to understand and manage one's emotions, as well as recognize and respond appropriately to the emotions of others, while taking responsibility for one's actions and decisions.**

Example: *A municipal social welfare officer exhibits emotional intelligence and accountability by actively listening to and empathizing with the concerns of constituents, while also taking responsibility for ensuring that social services and assistance programs are implemented effectively and with integrity.*

Tagalog: Ang kakayahang maunawaan at mapangasiwaan ang sariling damdamin, pati na rin ang matamong maunawaan at makapagbigay ng angkop na tugon sa damdamin ng iba, habang tinatanggap ang pananagutan sa sariling gawa at desisyon.

3. 1. 12 Ethics and Integrity

- **The adherence to moral and ethical principles, values, and standards of conduct, demonstrating honesty, fairness, and a commitment to serving the public interest.**

Example: *A municipal treasurer upholds ethics and integrity by ensuring transparent and accountable management of public funds, adhering to strict financial policies and procedures, and promoting a culture of fiscal responsibility within the local government unit.*

Tagalog: Ang pagsunod sa moralidad at etika, mga halaga, at pamantayan ng pag-uugali, ipinapakita ang katapatan, katarungan, at pangakong maglingkod sa kapakanan ng publiko.

3. 2 Self-Assessment on CSW Competencies

3. 2 Self-Assessment on CSW Competencies

This tool is designed to help you evaluate your current level of proficiency in the core competencies essential for effective CSW. By completing this survey, you will gain insights into your strengths and areas for development, which will inform your learning journey during the CSW training and beyond.

The survey consists of a series of questions related to each CSW competency. You will rate your proficiency level for each question using the following scale:

Rating: **1: Novice, 2: Beginner, 3: Emerging, 4: Intermediate, 5: Proficient, 6: Advanced, 7: Expert**

3. 2 Self-Assessment on CSW Competencies

1. **NOVICE**: I am new to this area and have very little knowledge or experience. I need a lot of guidance and direction to complete related tasks and often find myself struggling to understand basic concepts and terminology.
2. **BEGINNER**: I have a general understanding of the basics in this area. With some guidance and support, I can complete simple tasks. I'm actively learning and starting to apply the essential skills and knowledge needed to grow my competency.
3. **EMERGING**: My understanding in this area is developing, and I can independently handle routine tasks. I'm becoming more familiar and comfortable with the concepts and processes, although I may still need occasional guidance or clarification.

3. 2 Self-Assessment on CSW Competencies

4. **INTERMEDIATE**: I have a reliable grasp of this area and can independently manage most tasks. I can identify and solve common problems, and I'm able to provide insights based on my accumulated experience and knowledge.
5. **PROFICIENT**: I have a strong understanding of this area and can confidently navigate complex tasks with minimal guidance. I actively share my knowledge and provide support to others. I'm committed to continuous learning and proactively seek opportunities to enhance my skills.
6. **ADVANCED**: I possess a deep, comprehensive understanding of this area and can effectively apply my expertise to tackle different challenges. I'm able to develop creative solutions, anticipate potential issues, and provide valuable guidance and leadership to support the growth of others.

3. 2 Self-Assessment on CSW Competencies

7. **EXPERT**: I am widely recognized as a leading authority in this area, with an extensive understanding that allows me to excel in the most complex and demanding situations. I actively contribute to shaping this area by pioneering innovative approaches and methodologies. I provide strategic direction and leadership to drive significant advancements and improvements at the highest levels.

3. 2 Self-Assessment on CSW Competencies

Please answer each question honestly and to the best of your knowledge by **ENCIRCLING** your **SELF-RATING** on the question. Your responses will be kept confidential and will only be used to tailor the CSW training and development programs to meet your individual needs and support your growth as a CSW practitioner.

See the separate Questionnaire for more details.

3.3 Action Planning on Strengthening CSW Competencies

3.3 Action Planning on Strengthening CSW Competencies

1. Review your CSW Competency Assessment results

- Identify your strengths and areas for improvement based on your self-ratings.
- Reflect on the competencies where you rated yourself as "Novice," "Beginner," or "Emerging."
- Consider the competencies that are most critical to your current role and future career aspirations.

3.3 Action Planning on Strengthening CSW Competencies

2. Set SMART goals

- Develop 2-3 specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound (SMART) goals for enhancing your CSW competencies.
- Focus on the areas where you have the greatest opportunity for growth and that align with your professional development objectives.
- Write down your goals clearly and concisely.
  - *Example goal: "Improve my problem-solving and decision-making skills by completing a course on structured problem-solving techniques within the next 3 months."*

3. 3 Action Planning on Strengthening CSW Competencies

3. Identify action steps

- Break down each goal into smaller, actionable steps that you can take to achieve your objectives.
- Consider various learning and development activities, such as training programs, workshops, mentoring, job shadowing, or self-study.
- Assign a timeline and priority level to each action step to help you stay organized and focused.

3. 3 Action Planning on Strengthening CSW Competencies

4. Identify resources and support

- Determine the resources, tools, or support you may need to achieve your goals and complete your action steps.
- Consider seeking guidance or mentorship from colleagues, supervisors, or experts in the relevant competency areas.
- Identify any potential barriers or challenges you may face and brainstorm strategies to overcome them.

3. 3 Action Planning on Strengthening CSW Competencies

5. Review and commit to your action plan

- Review your completed action plan to ensure that your goals, action steps, and resources are clear, realistic, and aligned with your overall professional development objectives.
- Make any necessary revisions or adjustments based on your review.
- Commit to implementing your action plan and holding yourself accountable for making progress towards your goals.

Remember, strengthening your CSW competencies is an ongoing process that requires dedication, effort, and continuous learning. By developing and following through on your personal action plan, you are taking a proactive step towards enhancing your skills, knowledge, and overall effectiveness as a local government official or staff member.

Feel free to seek guidance or support from your colleagues, supervisors, or the CSW training facilitators as you work on implementing your action plan. Regularly review and update your plan as you make progress and identify new opportunities for growth and development.

SESSION 4

CSW Step 1: Analyze the Context

Session 4

ANALYZE THE CONTEXT

First Step of the CSW Process

Objective: To understand the current situation, identify stakeholders, and consider external factors that may impact the decision-making process.

Session 4

ANALYZE THE CONTEXT

First Step of the CSW Process

- Understanding Stakeholders and Their Interests
- Analyzing External Factors
- Reviewing Policies, Guidelines, and Regulations

4.1 Understanding Stakeholders and their Interests

- **Identify key stakeholders affected by or interested in the proposal or report**
  - Engage stakeholders early in the CSW process to gather their input and insights
- **Analyze stakeholder interests, needs, and concerns**
  - Understand their priorities and expectations to inform problem definition and solution development
- **Assess the potential impact of the proposal or report on different stakeholder groups**
  - Consider both positive and negative impacts to optimize benefits and mitigate risks

Understanding Stakeholders and their Interests

One of the critical steps in the Completed Staff Work (CSW) process is understanding the stakeholders involved and their respective interests. This section highlights the importance of stakeholder analysis and engagement throughout the CSW journey.

As we delve into this aspect, it is crucial to identify the key stakeholders who will be affected by or have an interest in the proposal or report being developed. These stakeholders could be individuals, groups, organizations, or communities that have a vested interest in the outcome of the staff work.

Engaging stakeholders early in the CSW process is highly recommended. By gathering their input and insights from the outset, you can gain valuable perspectives that will inform your problem definition and solution development. This proactive approach fosters a collaborative environment and ensures that diverse viewpoints are considered.

A thorough analysis of stakeholder interests, needs, and concerns is essential.

Understanding their priorities and expectations will provide valuable context and help shape the direction of your staff work. This analysis should consider both the potential positive and negative impacts of the proposal or report on different stakeholder groups, allowing you to optimize benefits and mitigate risks.

Developing a stakeholder engagement plan is a strategic step in the CSW process. By involving stakeholders throughout the journey, you can build understanding, support, and a sense of ownership among those affected. Regular communication and opportunities for feedback can help address concerns and ensure that the final proposal or report aligns with the needs and expectations of key stakeholders.

Ultimately, aligning the proposal or report with the interests of key decision-makers is crucial for successful approval. Tailoring the content and presentation to address their priorities and concerns will increase the likelihood of buy-in and support for the recommended course of action.

By following these principles of stakeholder analysis and engagement, you can ensure that your staff work is comprehensive, inclusive, and responsive to the diverse needs and interests of those involved, ultimately leading to more informed and impactful decision-making.

4.1 Understanding Stakeholders and their Interests

- **Develop a stakeholder engagement plan**
  - Involve stakeholders throughout the CSW process to build understanding, support, and ownership
- **Align the proposal or report with the interests of key decision-makers**
  - Tailor the content and presentation to address their priorities and concerns for successful approval

4. 2 Analyzing External Factors

- **Identify relevant trends, opportunities, and challenges in the external environment**
  - Consider political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental factors
- **Analyze best practices, innovations, and lessons learned from other LGUs or organizations**
  - Adapt and apply relevant insights to enhance the quality and impact of the proposal or report

4. 2 Analyzing External Factors

- **Develop strategies to leverage opportunities and mitigate risks in the external environment**
  - Proactively plan for potential changes or disruptions that may affect implementation
- **Define key performance indicators and success metrics based on external benchmarks**
  - Set realistic targets and measure progress to demonstrate value and impact to stakeholders

Analyzing External Factors

As we progress through the Completed Staff Work (CSW) process, it is crucial to analyze the external factors that may influence the proposal or report being developed. This section highlights the importance of considering the broader context and environment in which the staff work will be implemented.

One of the key steps is to identify relevant trends, opportunities, and challenges in the external environment. This involves a comprehensive analysis of various factors, including political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental aspects. By understanding these external forces, you can better anticipate potential obstacles and capitalize on emerging opportunities.

Analyzing best practices, innovations, and lessons learned from other local government units (LGUs) or organizations can provide valuable insights. By studying successful initiatives and learning from the experiences of others, you can adapt and apply relevant strategies to enhance the quality and impact of your proposal or report.

Developing strategies to leverage opportunities and mitigate risks in the external environment is essential. This proactive approach allows you to plan for potential changes or disruptions that may affect the implementation of your staff work. By anticipating and addressing external factors, you can increase the likelihood of successful execution and sustainable outcomes.

Defining key performance indicators (KPIs) and success metrics based on external benchmarks is another crucial aspect of this stage. By setting realistic targets and measuring progress against industry standards or best practices, you can demonstrate the value and impact of your proposal or report to stakeholders. This data-driven approach fosters accountability and continuous improvement.

By thoroughly analyzing external factors, you can ensure that your staff work is well-informed, responsive to the broader context, and positioned for success in the ever-changing landscape of local governance.

4. 3 Reviewing Policies, Guidelines, and Regulations

- Identify relevant internal and external policies, guidelines, and regulations
- Ensure the proposal or report aligns with and complies with these requirements
- Review the implications of these policies and regulations on the proposal or report
- Consider any necessary revisions or updates to support effective implementation
- Involve key LGU offices and personnel in the review process

Reviewing Policies, Guidelines, and Regulations

As part of analyzing the context for a proposal or report, it is crucial to identify and review all relevant internal and external policies, guidelines, and regulations. This ensures that the proposed solution aligns with and complies with existing requirements and frameworks.

The key steps in this process include:

- Identifying all applicable policies, guidelines, and regulations from both internal LGU sources (e.g. municipal ordinances, administrative orders) and external sources (e.g. national laws, BARMM policies).

- Thoroughly reviewing the content of these policies and regulations to understand their implications for the proposal or report being developed. This may require collaborating with the LGU's Legal Office and other key departments.

- Assessing potential legal risks, ethical considerations, and accountability requirements based on the identified policies and regulations. Proactively

requirements based on the identified policies and regulations. Proactively addressing and mitigating these risks in the proposal.

- Considering if any revisions or updates to existing policies/regulations are needed to effectively implement the proposed solution.

- Involving relevant LGU offices and subject matter experts in this review process to ensure a comprehensive understanding of compliance requirements.

- Establishing clear mechanisms for monitoring, evaluating, and reporting compliance with relevant policies and regulations during implementation.

- Regularly tracking adherence and demonstrating how the proposal/report aligns with mandated guidelines and regulations.

By thoroughly reviewing policies, guidelines, and regulations, potential conflicts or legal issues can be identified early and addressed. This enhances the feasibility, credibility and accountability of the final proposal or report submitted to decision-makers.

4. 3 Reviewing Policies, Guidelines, and Regulations

- Collaborate with the Legal Office, Planning and Development Office, and relevant departments
- Assess potential legal, ethical, and accountability risks and considerations
- Proactively address and mitigate these risks in the proposal or report
- Establish mechanisms for monitoring, evaluating, and reporting compliance
- Regularly track and demonstrate adherence to relevant policies, guidelines, and regulations

Activity:
Context Analysis

SESSION 5

CSW Step 2: Define the Problem or Need

Session 5

DEFINE THE PROBLEM OR NEED

Second Step of the CSW Process

Objective: To clearly define the problem or need, identify its root causes, and consider its impact on stakeholders.

Session 5

DEFINE THE PROBLEM OR NEED

Second Step of the CSW Process

- Techniques for Defining the Problem
- Identifying Root Causes
- Assessing Impact

5.1 Techniques for Defining the Problem

- Articulate the problem clearly and concisely
- Define the problem's nature, scope, and significance
- Use data and evidence to validate and quantify the problem
- Identify key questions the problem definition should answer
- What is the current situation?
- What are the desired outcomes or changes?

Techniques for Defining the Problem

Articulating the problem clearly and concisely is crucial for ensuring that everyone involved understands the issue at hand and can work towards an effective solution. Some key techniques include:

- Define the problem's nature, scope, and significance in straightforward terms, avoiding ambiguity or jargon.

- Use data, facts, and evidence to validate the existence of the problem and quantify its impact where possible. This helps establish the problem as a genuine concern worthy of attention.

- Identify the key questions that the problem definition should answer, such as:
  - What is the current situation or status quo that is problematic?
  - What are the desired outcomes or changes needed to resolve the problem?
  - What barriers, challenges or root causes are preventing those outcomes from being achieved?

- Frame the problem statement in terms of its impact on key stakeholders (e.g. constituents, businesses, municipal departments) and the LGU as a whole. This highlights the importance and relevance of addressing the issue.

- Emphasize the urgency of tackling the problem by outlining the risks or consequences of inaction. This can help prioritize the issue appropriately.

- Clearly define the boundaries and parameters of the problem to maintain a focused, manageable scope aligned with the LGU's mandate and available resources.

By applying these techniques, the problem definition becomes a clear, evidence-based statement that establishes a common understanding of the issue, its significance, and the need for a well-considered solution among all stakeholders involved.

5.1 Techniques for Defining the Problem

- What are the barriers or challenges to achieving these outcomes?
- Frame the problem in terms of its impact on stakeholders and the LGU
- Highlight the urgency and importance of addressing the problem
- Define the boundaries and parameters of the problem
- Ensure the problem is focused, manageable, and aligned with the LGU's mandate and resources

5. 2 Identifying Root Causes

- Analyze underlying factors, conditions, or behaviors contributing to the problem
- Use problem-solving tools like fishbone diagrams or root cause trees
- Prioritize the most critical or influential root causes
- Focus efforts and resources on addressing these key drivers
- Validate root cause analysis through stakeholder consultation and expert input
- Ensure a comprehensive and accurate understanding of the problem

Identifying Root Causes

After clearly articulating the problem statement, it is crucial to delve deeper and identify the underlying root causes contributing to the issue at hand. Simply addressing surface-level symptoms will likely provide only temporary relief, while the core drivers remain unresolved.

One effective approach is to analyze the various factors, conditions, or behaviors that may be fueling the problem. This can involve techniques like:

- Using problem-solving tools such as fishbone diagrams or root cause analysis trees to systematically break down and visualize the potential causes. These tools help uncover multiple layers of contributing factors.

- Engaging in group brainstorming sessions with relevant stakeholders to gather diverse perspectives on what might be driving the problem.

- Reviewing historical data, reports or case studies related to similar issues to identify recurring root causes.

Once potential root causes have been identified, it is important to prioritize them based on their criticality or influence over the problem. This allows efforts and resources to be focused on addressing the most significant drivers first.

Validating the root cause analysis through consultation with subject matter experts and key stakeholders is also essential. Their insights can help confirm or refine the understanding of core issues before finalizing proposed solutions.

Ultimately, the goal is to ensure a comprehensive and accurate understanding of the root causes underlying the problem. This lays a solid foundation for developing targeted, sustainable solutions that address the core issues rather than just treating symptoms.

By investing time and effort into rigorous root cause analysis, the municipal officials and staff increase the likelihood of proposing effective interventions that resolve problems at their source, leading to lasting positive change.

5. 3 Assessing Impact

- Measure the current and potential impact of the problem on stakeholders and the LGU
- Quantify social, economic, environmental, and political implications
- Evaluate the consequences of not addressing the problem
- Assess risks, costs, and missed opportunities
- Identify the potential benefits and value of solving the problem
- Demonstrate the feasibility and impact of the proposal or report

Assessing Impact

After clearly articulating the problem statement and identifying root causes, it is important to comprehensively assess the current and potential impacts of the issue. This helps build a strong case for why the problem merits attention and resources to address it.

Key steps in assessing impact include:

- Measuring the tangible effects the problem is having on different stakeholder groups (e.g. constituents, businesses, municipal departments) as well as the LGU as a whole. Quantify social, economic, environmental, and political implications where possible.

- Evaluating the consequences and risks of not addressing the problem, such as costs incurred, opportunities missed, or escalating negative impacts over time. This highlights the urgency of finding a solution.

- Identifying the potential benefits and value that could be unlocked by solving

the problem effectively. This could include enhanced service delivery, cost savings, improved economic outcomes, environmental protection etc.

- Demonstrating the feasibility and expected positive impact of any proposed interventions or solutions outlined in the staff work. Use evidence, data projections, and success metrics.

By thoroughly assessing the multi-dimensional impacts of the problem, the proposal builds a compelling case for decision-makers to prioritize the issue. It clearly articulates what is at stake, why action is needed, and how the LGU and community stand to benefit from implementing recommendations.

This impact assessment, combined with a clear problem statement and root cause analysis, provides the solid foundational justification required for the subsequent sections exploring potential solutions.

Workshop:

Crafting Problem Statements for Paglat LGU Issues

SESSION 6

CSW Step 3: Research and Analyze the Needed Info

Session 6

RESEARCH AND ANALYZE NEEDED INFORMATION

Third Step of the CSW Process

Objective: To gather and analyze relevant data and information to inform the decision-making process and identify potential solutions.

Session 6

RESEARCH AND ANALYZE NEEDED INFORMATION

Third Step of the CSW Process

- Types and Sources of Information
- Techniques for Gathering Data
- Analyzing and Synthesizing Information

6.1 Types and Sources of Information

- Identify key types of information needed (e.g., demographic, socio-economic, environmental)
- Determine the most relevant and reliable sources for each type
- Prioritize primary and secondary sources
- Consider internal records, government databases, academic research, community feedback
- Assess potential biases, limitations, or gaps in different sources
- Develop strategies to mitigate or address these issues

Types and Sources of Information

One of the first steps in the research phase is to identify the key types of information needed to comprehensively understand and analyze the issue or problem at hand. Depending on the nature of the staff work, this could include demographic data, socio-economic indicators, environmental factors, policy documents, technical specifications, and many other categories.

Once the information requirements have been mapped out, the next step is to determine the most relevant and reliable sources for each type of data needed. It is generally advisable to prioritize primary sources - information gathered directly from authoritative or first-hand sources like field studies, surveys, direct observations etc.

However, secondary sources like government databases, academic research papers, industry reports etc. can also provide valuable contextual information and insights. When using secondary data, it is important to assess the credibility of the sources and any potential biases, limitations or gaps that may exist.

For the Municipality of Paglat's staff work, relevant sources could include:

- Internal records and databases maintained by various municipal departments
- National and regional statistics from government agencies like PSA
- Environmental data from DENR, academic studies on local ecosystems
- Socio-economic surveys, feedback from community consultations
- Policy documents, laws and regulations from BARMM, national agencies

Regardless of the sources used, it is crucial to critically evaluate them for potential blind spots, conflicts of interest, or methodological weaknesses that could undermine data quality. Strategies like data triangulation from multiple sources can help mitigate these issues.

By carefully considering the types of information required and their most reliable sources upfront, the research efforts can be streamlined and focused on gathering comprehensive, high-quality data to inform the staff work.

6.2 Techniques for Gathering Data

- Select appropriate data collection methods (e.g., surveys, interviews, focus groups)
- Consider resource requirements, timelines, and target respondents
- Design valid and reliable data collection instruments aligned with research objectives
- Ensure questions are clear, unbiased, and comprehensive
- Establish quality control measures to ensure data accuracy, completeness, and integrity
- Implement data validation, cleaning, and security protocols

Techniques for Gathering Data

After defining the research objectives and information requirements, the next step is to determine the most appropriate methods for collecting the necessary data. This involves:

- Selecting suitable data collection methods such as surveys, interviews, focus group discussions, observations, or reviews of existing records and documentation. The choice should consider factors like resource requirements, timelines, and the target respondent groups.

- Designing data collection instruments (e.g. questionnaires, interview guides, observation checklists) that are valid, reliable, and well-aligned with the specific research objectives.

- Ensuring that questions or prompts are clear, unambiguous, unbiased, and comprehensive enough to gather all relevant information needed.

- Establishing robust quality control measures throughout the data collection

process to ensure accuracy, completeness, and integrity of the data being gathered. This could involve techniques like:

- Thorough training of data collectors
- Pilot testing instruments
- Implementing data validation rules
- Conducting spot-checks and audits

- Determining appropriate sample sizes and selection criteria if conducting surveys or interviews to ensure the data is statistically representative.

- Implementing strict data cleaning protocols to identify and address any errors, inconsistencies or missing values in the raw data collected.

- Enforcing data security and confidentiality measures, especially when dealing with sensitive or personal information.

By employing rigorous and systematic techniques for data gathering, the quality and reliability of the information underpinning the staff work is enhanced. This lays a solid foundation for comprehensive analysis and development of evidence-based recommendations.

6. 3 Analyzing and Synthesizing Information

- Identify key variables, trends, patterns, and relationships in the data
- Use statistical or qualitative analysis techniques to derive meaningful insights
- Triangulate findings from different sources and methods to ensure robustness
- Validate conclusions through stakeholder consultation and expert review
- Synthesize findings into clear, actionable categories or recommendations
- Use data visualization to effectively communicate insights to decision-makers

Analyzing and Synthesizing Information

Once relevant data has been collected through various methods, the next critical step is to analyze and synthesize that information into meaningful insights and recommendations. This involves:

- Identifying key variables, trends, patterns, and relationships within the data sets. This could involve using statistical analysis techniques like regression, correlation analysis, or qualitative methods like thematic coding depending on the nature of the information gathered.

- Triangulating findings from different data sources and collection methods to validate conclusions and ensure their robustness. Converging evidence from multiple perspectives enhances the credibility of the analysis.

- Validating preliminary conclusions and interpretations through consultation with subject matter experts and key stakeholders. Their feedback can refine the analysis and uncover blind spots.

- Synthesizing the validated findings into clear, actionable categories or specific recommendations that directly address the problem statement and research objectives. This moves the analysis from insights to concrete proposals for decision-makers to consider.

- Utilizing effective data visualization techniques like charts, graphs, maps etc. to communicate complex quantitative and qualitative insights in a clear, compelling manner for decision-makers.

By rigorously analyzing and synthesizing information through these techniques, the CSW process transforms raw data into high-quality intelligence that supports well-informed decision-making. Comprehensive analysis lays the groundwork for developing feasible, evidence-based solutions tailored to the specific context and needs of the LGU.

Activity:
Data Gathering

SESSION 7

CSW Step 4: Explore Options or Alternatives

Session 7

EXPLORE OPTIONS OR ALTERNATIVES

Fourth Step of the CSW Process

Objective: To generate and evaluate potential solutions to the problem or need, considering their feasibility, effectiveness, and sustainability.

Session 7

EXPLORE OPTIONS OR ALTERNATIVES

Fourth Step of the CSW Process

- Generating Potential Solutions
- Evaluating Solutions
- Identifying Allies

7.1 Generating Potential Solutions

- Brainstorm diverse solutions addressing root causes and stakeholder needs
- Encourage creative thinking and consider both incremental and transformative options
- Adapt best practices and innovations from other LGUs or organizations
- Tailor solutions to the specific context and priorities of the LGU
- Define criteria for evaluating solutions (e.g., feasibility, impact, cost-effectiveness)
- Ensure alignment with the LGU's values, goals, and resources

Generating Potential Solutions

Once the problem has been clearly defined and relevant information gathered, the next step is to generate a range of potential solutions to address the identified issues. This involves:

- Brainstorming a diverse set of possible solutions that tackle the root causes of the problem and meet the needs of key stakeholders.[1] Encourage creative and innovative thinking from the team.

- Considering both incremental improvements as well as more transformative or disruptive options that could provide step-change solutions.[1] Don't limit thinking to conventional approaches.

- Adapting and building upon best practices, successful innovations or effective solutions implemented by other LGUs or organizations facing similar challenges.[1] Leverage insights from others while tailoring them to the local context.

- Ensuring proposed solutions align with the specific priorities, values, goals and available resources of the LGU.[1] Solutions must be viable within the LGU's mandate and capabilities.

- Defining clear criteria for evaluating and comparing the different solution options.[1] This could include factors like feasibility, potential impact, cost-effectiveness, risks, timelines etc.

- Involving a cross-section of stakeholders and subject matter experts in ideation sessions to gather diverse perspectives and specialized knowledge.[1]

By employing these techniques, a comprehensive range of creative yet practical solution options can be generated and objectively assessed. This provides decision-makers with multiple paths forward supported by evidence and analysis.

7. 2 Evaluating Solutions

- Conduct a SWOT analysis of each potential solution
- Assess strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats
- Use decision-making tools (e.g., multi-criteria analysis, cost-benefit analysis)
- Systematically compare and prioritize solutions based on predefined criteria
- Engage stakeholders and experts in the evaluation process
- Gather diverse perspectives, build consensus, and secure buy-in for the selected

Evaluating Solutions

Once a range of potential solutions has been generated, the next critical step is to rigorously evaluate each option to determine the most viable and impactful approach. This involves:

- Conducting a SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) analysis for each proposed solution. This structured technique helps identify the internal strengths and weaknesses, as well as external opportunities and threats associated with each option.

- Utilizing decision-making tools and frameworks to systematically compare and prioritize solutions against predefined criteria. Examples include multi-criteria analysis to weigh different factors, and cost-benefit analysis to assess financial implications.

- Engaging key stakeholders and subject matter experts throughout the evaluation process. Their diverse perspectives, specialized knowledge, and feedback are invaluable in validating assessments and building consensus

around the most appropriate solution.

The evaluation criteria should be clearly defined and aligned with the LGU's goals, priorities, and constraints. Typical criteria may include:

- Feasibility of implementation (technical, financial, operational)
- Potential impact and effectiveness in addressing root causes
- Cost-effectiveness and optimal use of resources
- Risks and potential unintended consequences
- Alignment with policies, regulations, and LGU mandate
- Stakeholder acceptability and sustainability

By employing these rigorous evaluation techniques, the staff work can provide a comprehensive, evidence-based analysis of the strengths, limitations, and trade-offs associated with each solution option. This enables decision-makers to make well-informed choices about the most viable path forward.

Ultimately, the evaluation process should build consensus and secure buy-in from key stakeholders for the selected solution. Their input enhances the credibility and legitimacy of the final recommendation.

7. 3 Identifying Allies

- Map stakeholders' interest, influence, and potential contribution to the solution
- Prioritize engagement with key allies who can champion the proposal or provide resources
- Develop targeted communication and engagement strategies for each ally
- Highlight shared goals, benefits, and opportunities for collaboration
- Establish partnerships and coalitions to support solution implementation
- Leverage allies' networks, expertise, and resources to enhance feasibility and impact

Identifying Allies

Once potential solutions have been generated and evaluated, it is crucial to identify key allies who can support and champion the recommended approach. This involves:

- Mapping stakeholders based on their level of interest in the issue, their influence over decision-making, and their potential to contribute resources or expertise towards implementing the solution.

- Prioritizing engagement with stakeholders who emerge as key allies - those who stand to significantly benefit from the proposed solution and have the motivation and means to advocate for its adoption.

- Developing targeted communication and engagement strategies tailored to the specific interests and priorities of each identified ally group. Clear messaging highlighting shared goals, benefits, and opportunities for collaboration is essential.

- Proactively establishing partnerships and coalitions with allied stakeholders to build a broad base of support for the recommended solution. Formalizing these relationships through agreements or joint working groups can enhance commitment.

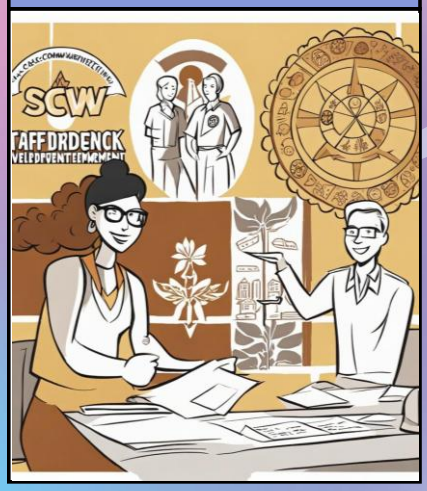
- Leveraging the networks, specialized expertise, and resources that allies can provide to strengthen the feasibility and potential impact of the proposed solution during implementation.

By systematically identifying and cultivating relationships with key allies, the staff work can demonstrate broad stakeholder buy-in and highlight the collaborative approach taken in solution development. This enhances the credibility and perceived legitimacy of the final recommendation presented to decision-makers.

Ultimately, building a strong coalition of allies increases the likelihood that the proposed solution will be approved and successfully implemented by harnessing the collective efforts, influence and resources of supportive stakeholder groups.

Activity:

Generating, Evaluating, and Finalizing Solutions



SESSION 8

CSW Step 5: Submit Proposal or Report

Session 8

SUBMIT PROPOSAL OR REPORT

Fifth Step of the CSW Process

Objective: To present the proposed solution and decision-making process to the principal/primary stakeholders, ensuring transparency and accountability in the decision-making process.

Session 8

SUBMIT PROPOSAL OR REPORT

Fifth Step of the CSW Process

- Components of a CSW Proposal
- Drafting a CSW Proposal
- Effective Presentation Techniques

8.1 Components of a CSW Proposal

- Executive summary: Overview of the problem, proposed solution, and expected impact
- Background and context: Detailed description of the problem and its significance
- Methodology: Explanation of the research, analysis, and decision-making process
- Recommendations: Clear, actionable steps to implement the proposed solution

Components of a CSW Proposal

When presenting the final CSW proposal to decision-makers, it is crucial to organize and structure the content in a clear and comprehensive manner. A well-crafted proposal should include the following components:

Executive Summary
This section provides a concise overview of the problem being addressed, the proposed solution, and the expected impact or benefits of implementing the recommendation. It serves as an easily digestible synopsis for decision-makers.

Background and Context
This component offers a detailed description and analysis of the problem, its root causes, and its significance or urgency. It outlines the current situation, challenges faced, and the need for action, substantiated by relevant data, evidence and stakeholder perspectives.

Methodology
Here, the proposal explains the rigorous process followed in researching,

analyzing and developing the recommendation. This includes the data collection methods employed, analytical techniques used, evaluation of alternatives, and the criteria applied in selecting the proposed solution.

Recommendations
This is the core of the proposal, presenting clear, specific and actionable steps for implementing the proposed solution. The recommendations should directly address the root causes identified and align with the LGU's goals, policies and available resources.

Implementation Plan
An effective implementation plan outlines the timeline, resources required (financial, human, technical), roles and responsibilities of involved parties, and key milestones for executing the recommended actions. This section demonstrates the feasibility and readiness for operationalizing the solution.

Monitoring and Evaluation
This component defines how progress, performance and ultimate impact of the implemented solution will be tracked, measured and reported. It specifies the metrics, data sources, and mechanisms for monitoring to ensure accountability and enable course-correction if needed.

By comprehensively covering these components, the CSW proposal provides decision-makers with a complete, well-structured package that guides their understanding, facilitates effective deliberation, and enables them to make an informed choice.

8.1 Components of a CSW Proposal

- Implementation plan: Timeline, resources, roles, and responsibilities for execution
- Monitoring and evaluation: How progress and impact will be tracked and reported

8. 2 Drafting a CSW Proposal

- Develop a clear, compelling narrative that communicates the value and urgency of the proposal
- Use evidence, examples, and storytelling to engage and persuade the audience
- Structure the proposal logically, with clear connections between sections
- Use headings, bullet points, and visuals to enhance readability and understanding
- Tailor language and content to the needs and preferences of key decision-makers
- Anticipate and address potential questions, concerns, or objections

Drafting a CSW Proposal

Once all the components of the CSW process have been completed - problem definition, research, analysis of options - it is time to compile the staff work into a comprehensive written proposal for decision-makers. This involves:

- Developing a clear, compelling narrative that articulates the value proposition and urgency behind the proposal's recommendations. Use evidence, real-world examples, and storytelling techniques to engage the audience and persuade them of the importance of taking action.

- Structuring the proposal in a logical, easy-to-follow manner, with clear connections and transitions between different sections. The flow should guide the reader through the background, analysis, and ultimately to the proposed solution.

- Enhancing readability and comprehension by effectively using formatting elements like headings, bullet points, tables, and visualizations (charts, diagrams, etc.). These techniques help distill complex information into digestible

components.

- Tailoring the language, level of detail, and overall content to align with the specific needs, expertise, and preferences of the primary decision-makers who will receive the proposal. Customize accordingly.

- Anticipating potential questions, concerns or objections decision-makers may raise, and proactively addressing them within the proposal using evidence and sound reasoning.

- Using an objective, neutral tone that prioritizes facts over opinions or subjective judgments. Avoid hedging language or moralization.

By drafting the CSW proposal thoughtfully and adhering to best practices in technical writing, staff can ensure their comprehensive staff work culminates in a clear, persuasive, and actionable document for decision-makers to review.

8. 3 Effective Presentation Techniques

- Define clear objectives and key messages for the presentation
- Align content and delivery to the needs and interests of the audience
- Use engaging visuals, examples, and stories to illustrate key points
- Limit text on slides and focus on conveying main ideas
- Practice delivery to enhance confidence, clarity, and impact
- Anticipate and prepare for potential questions or challenges

Effective Presentation Techniques

After all the hard work of developing a comprehensive CSW proposal, the final step is to effectively present and communicate the recommendations to decision-makers. This involves:

- Defining clear objectives and key messages that should be conveyed during the presentation. Having a focused goal in mind helps shape an impactful narrative.

- Aligning both the content and delivery style to the specific needs, backgrounds, and interests of the target audience. Tailor the level of detail, use of technical language, and emphasis based on what will resonate most.

- Utilizing engaging visuals aids like charts, diagrams, photos, and videos to illustrate key points and data in a compelling manner. Real-world examples and relatable stories can also help make abstract concepts more tangible.

- Limiting excessive text on presentation slides and instead focusing slides on conveying just the main ideas or headlines. The slides should complement the

speaker's narrative rather than replicating the entire proposal.

- Practicing the delivery multiple times to build confidence, clarity, and impactful presence when presenting. This helps ingrain timing, smooth transitions, and anticipation of potential questions.

- Anticipating likely questions or challenges decision-makers may raise, and preparing clear explanations or rebuttals supported by evidence from the proposal.

By employing these presentation techniques, the staff work can culminate in a polished, persuasive pitch that clearly articulates the rationale, benefits, and implementation plan for the proposed solution.[1] An effective presentation enhances credibility and increases the likelihood of securing approval for recommendations.

Workshop:

Drafting and Presenting a Completed Staff Work Proposal for a Paglat LGU Initiative

WRITESHOP

CSW Guidelines for Major Local Governance Processes

WRITESHOP

CSW Guidelines for Major Local Governance Processes / Areas in Paglat

- Drafting of CSW Guidelines
- Refining the CSW Guidelines
- Presentation and Feedback

9.1 Drafting of CSW Guidelines

- Identify key areas or processes that require CSW guidelines
- Prioritize based on potential impact, complexity, or risk
- Engage relevant stakeholders in the drafting process
- Incorporate diverse perspectives and ensure guidelines are feasible and relevant
- Align guidelines with existing policies, regulations, and best practices
- Ensure consistency and compliance with internal and external requirements

Drafting of CSW Guidelines

One of the first steps in institutionalizing the Completed Staff Work (CSW) approach is to develop clear guidelines tailored to the specific areas and processes where it will be applied. This helps ensure consistent implementation and maximizes the benefits of CSW across the local government unit.

The key considerations in drafting CSW guidelines include:

- Identifying the key areas or processes that require dedicated CSW guidelines based on their potential impact, complexity, or associated risks if not done properly. Examples could include policy development, project management, budgeting, or specific service areas like health or education programs.

- Prioritizing which areas to focus on first, considering factors like existing capacity gaps, level of stakeholder interest, or alignment with the LGU's strategic priorities.

- Engaging relevant internal and external stakeholders in the drafting process to

incorporate diverse perspectives. This helps ensure the guidelines are comprehensive, feasible to implement, and responsive to actual needs on the ground.

- Incorporating best practices and lessons learned from other LGUs or organizations that have successfully implemented CSW. This allows Paglat to build on proven approaches while tailoring them to the local context.

- Ensuring the draft guidelines align with and do not contradict existing policies, regulations, and legal requirements at the municipal, regional or national level. Consistency and compliance are crucial for effective institutionalization.

- Developing guidelines that are clear, user-friendly and actionable, with specific steps, tools, templates and quality standards to guide staff in applying CSW.

By following a participatory and context-driven approach to drafting CSW guidelines, the Municipality of Paglat can develop robust frameworks that are widely accepted, understood and utilized across its governance functions.

9. 2 Refining the CSW Guidelines

- Review draft guidelines with key stakeholders and experts
- Gather feedback and suggestions for improvement
- Assess the clarity, comprehensiveness, and usability of the guidelines
- Revise and streamline as needed to ensure effective implementation
- Develop supporting materials (e.g., templates, checklists, FAQs)
- Facilitate consistent application of the guidelines across the LGU

Refining the CSW Guidelines

Once draft CSW guidelines have been developed for key governance areas in the Municipality of Paglat, the next critical step is to refine and validate them through a review process. This involves:

- Engaging key internal and external stakeholders who will be directly involved in implementing the CSW guidelines. This includes municipal department heads, process owners, subject matter experts and end-users.

- Gathering comprehensive feedback and suggestions for improvement from these stakeholder groups. Their practical insights are invaluable for identifying potential gaps, areas of confusion or aspects that need further clarification in the draft guidelines.

- Conducting a thorough assessment of the clarity, comprehensiveness and overall usability of the draft guidelines based on the consolidated feedback received. Are they easy to understand and follow? Are any critical elements missing?

- Revising and streamlining the guidelines as needed to enhance their effectiveness based on stakeholder input. This may involve restructuring sections, simplifying language, adding examples or trimming redundant content.

- Developing supporting materials and tools to accompany the guidelines and facilitate their consistent implementation across the LGU. Examples could include templates, checklists, FAQ documents and training modules.

- Facilitating review sessions and workshops to socialize the refined guidelines, build understanding among staff, and gather further feedback prior to official rollout.

By iteratively refining the CSW guidelines through this multi-stakeholder review process, the Municipality of Paglat can ensure the final versions are comprehensive, user-friendly and aligned with the actual needs of those responsible for operationalizing them on a daily basis. This improves adoption, standardizes CSW implementation and ultimately enhances governance capabilities.

9. 2 Presentation and Feedback on the CSW Guidelines

- Present the refined guidelines to relevant LGU officials and staff
- Highlight the benefits and implications for their work
- Conduct training or orientation sessions on the new guidelines
- Ensure staff understand and can apply the guidelines effectively
- Establish a feedback mechanism to gather input on implementation challenges or successes
- Use feedback to continuously improve and update the guidelines as needed

Presentation and Feedback on the CSW Guidelines

After the draft CSW guidelines have been reviewed and refined based on stakeholder input, the next critical step is to formally present them to relevant LGU officials and staff. This helps build awareness, understanding and buy-in for the new guidelines across the organization.

During the presentation, it is important to highlight the key benefits and implications that the guidelines will have on the day-to-day work of officials and staff. Clearly articulate how adhering to the CSW process will enhance decision-making, improve service delivery, increase transparency and drive better outcomes for Paglat's constituents.

In addition to the presentation, conduct comprehensive training or orientation sessions to ensure all impacted personnel fully understand the guidelines and how to apply them effectively. Use practical examples, case studies and hands-on activities to reinforce the CSW concepts and requirements.

Establishing a robust feedback mechanism is also crucial at this stage. Provide

multiple channels (surveys, focus groups, hotlines etc.) for officials and staff to share their experiences, challenges or successes in implementing the new CSW guidelines. This feedback is invaluable for identifying potential gaps or areas for improvement.

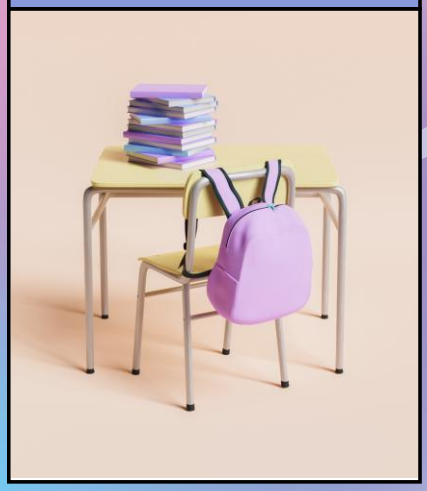
Consistently review and analyze the feedback received through this mechanism. Use these insights to continuously refine and update the CSW guidelines over time, ensuring they remain relevant, practical and aligned with the evolving needs of the municipality.

By taking a structured approach to presenting the guidelines, providing comprehensive training, and proactively soliciting feedback, the LGU can drive effective institutionalization of the CSW process across all governance functions. This iterative cycle of implementation and improvement will enhance Paglat's capacity for evidence-based decision-making and responsive local governance.

Details TEMPLATE

- Content
- Content
- Content

The power of communication



Overcoming nervousness

Confidence-building strategies

Selecting visual aids

Enhancing your presentation

Effective delivery techniques

Voice modulation is a powerful tool in public speaking. It involves varying pitch, tone, and volume to convey emotion, emphasize points, and maintain interest.

- Pitch variation
- Tone inflection
- Volume control

Effective body language enhances your message, making it more impactful and memorable.

- Meaningful eye contact
- Purposeful gestures
- Maintain good posture
- Control your expressions

Navigating Q&A sessions

Maintaining composure during the Q&A session is essential for projecting confidence and authority. Consider the following tips for staying composed:

- Stay calm
- Actively listen
- Pause and reflect
- Maintain eye contact

- Know your material in advance
- Anticipate common questions
- Rehearse your responses

Speaking impact

- Your ability to communicate effectively will leave a lasting impact on your audience
- Effectively communicating involves not only delivering a message but also resonating with the experiences, values, and emotions of those listening

Dynamic delivery

- Learn to infuse energy into your delivery to leave a lasting impression
- One of the goals of effective communication is to motivate your audience

Metric	Measurement	Target	Actual
Audience attendance	# of attendees	150	120
Engagement duration	Minutes	60	75
Q&A interaction	# of questions	10	15
Positive feedback	Percentage (%)	90	95

Final tips & takeaways

- Continue improving
- Seek feedback
- Reflect on performance
- Explore new techniques
- Set personal goals
- Iterate and adapt

Consistent rehearsal
- Strengthen your familiarity

Refine delivery style
- Pacing, tone, and emphasis

Timing and transitions
- Aim for seamless, professional delivery

Practice audience
- Enlist colleagues to listen & provide feedback

Speaking engagement metrics

Impact factor	Measurement	Target	Achieved
Audience interaction	Percentage (%)	85	88
Knowledge retention	Percentage (%)	75	80
Post-presentation surveys	Average rating	4.2	4.5
Referral rate	Percentage (%)	10	12

Thank you

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